

Tab 1

20 Minutes for the Win!

The Quintessential Handbook

On

Winning in Parliamentary Debate



Karen Kenyon

The Table of Contents

Part 1 – Jump Right In – The Water’s Fine

Dipping Your Toes Into Parliamentary Debate

Chapter 1	The Nuts and Bolts -- The Basics of Parli Debate	1
Chapter 2	Follow the Boy Scout Motto: Be Prepared	5
Chapter 3	The Whole Enchilada (Or What Every Debate Speech Needs)	6
Chapter 4	On your Mark, Get Set, and Go! Using your Prep Time	11
Chapter 5	If You Build It, They Will Come -- Constructing Effective Contentions	14
Chapter 6	Tear Down that Wall – Effectively Attacking Arguments	15
Chapter 7	It All Boils Down to the Evidence or Does It?	17
Chapter 8	Go with the Flow – Taking Notes on Your Debate	20
Chapter 9	“Me Talk Pretty One Day” – Delivering a Great Debate Speech	23
Chapter 10	No One Told Me This Was My Job! – Each Team Member’s Responsibilities	26
	First Affirmation	26
	First Negation	28
	Second Affirmation	31
	Second Negation	33
Chapter 11	POC, POI (No, not the Hawaiian Kind) and POO (No, not the Dog Kind) – Points of Clarification, Points of Information, and Points of Order	35
Chapter 12	The Best Laid Plans -- Creating an Affirmation Plan for a Policy Proposition	38
Chapter 13	Fiat – No, We’re Not Talking Cars Here!	40
Chapter 14	Choose Your Weapons -- Attacking the Affirmation’s Plan	42
Chapter 15	Debate Is, Pardon My Expression, the S.H.I.T.S – A Review of Some of the Best Generic Attacks	46
Chapter 16	You’re Going Down! Winning in Rebuttals	48
Chapter 17	Taking It to the Next Level – A Few More Tips on Refining your Debating Skills	51

Chapter 18	There's No Better Time Than the Present (Or Going to your First Tournament)	54
Chapter 19	Armchair Debating – From the Comfort of your own Home (AKA Going to your First Online Tournament)	60
Chapter 20	Judgment Day: What Judges Look for When Making their Decisions	62

Part 2 – Running with the Big Dogs!

Chapter 21	Weighing In – Tipping the Scale in your Favor! A Closer Look at the Weighing Mechanism	64
Chapter 22	Hold on a Minute – Plan B Has Just Entered the Building – the Negative Counterplan	66
Chapter 23	If the Shoe Fits, Wear It or Standard Types of Counterplans to Try On	69
Chapter 24	So What's An Affirmation Team to Do? Countering the Counterplan	72
Chapter 25	Tech and Theory in Parli Debate – We Aren't Talking Computers Here	
Chapter 26	Theory Argument	
Chapter 27	Metaphor Topics – Beautiful Chaos!	78

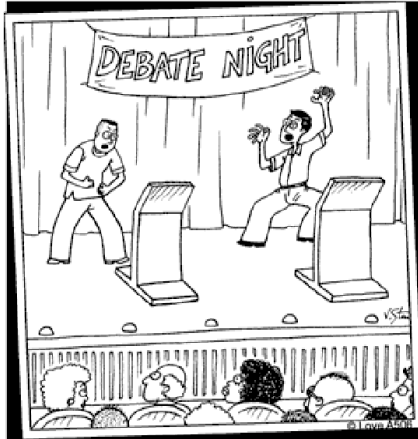
Addendum

Addendum 1 – Handy, Dandy Glossary on All Things Debate	83
Addendum 2 – Speaking “Advanced Parli”	88
Addendum 3 – A Tasty Sampling – Some Past Parliamentary Topics from Tournaments	90
Addendum 4 – Starting Off on the Right Foot – Effective Parli Introductions	71
Addendum 5 – What's A Speaker to Do? Helpful Cheat Sheets	93
Addendum 6 – What Would Hobbs and Locke Tell You to Say	98
Addendum 7 – Straight from the Horses' Mouth – CHSSA and NPD L Rules that Govern Parliamentary Debate	100

Chapter 1

The Nuts and bolts – The Basics of Parli Debate

What is parli debate?



Opening arguments would begin after the intimidation round.

It is a form of extemporaneous debate where two teams debate a **proposition** (AKA a **resolution** or **motion**) that they are given only 20 minutes (30 minutes for Novice) before the round starts. One team affirms the proposition (is in favor of it) and one team negates the proposition (is against it).

The team in favor of the resolution is known by several names: the **Affirmation**, the **Government**, or the **Affirmative**. The team opposed to the resolution is known as the **Negation** or the **Opposition**.

What is the proposition or motion in a parliamentary debate?

It is the topic being debated. There are three kinds of propositions –

- **Statements of fact** – these resolutions are opinions that are stated as facts. Both teams try to prove that the fact is true or false. Example: The current president has done more harm than good.

****How can you tell if a topic is a **fact** topic?** Ask yourself if there is a simple “yes” or “no” answer or if they have stated an opinion as a fact.

- **Questions of value** – both sides push for their value (principle or standard) as superior to the other side’s value. Example: Using alternative sources of energy is more important than economic considerations.

****How can you tell if a topic is a **value** topic?** Ask yourself if it asks which of two options is better or if it asks you to place importance on some standard or principle.

Sometimes, a value topic gives the Affirmative an opportunity to choose the value they want to emphasize. Example: The US should place a greater value on international aid.

With this wording, the AFF team could decide what to value – feeding the hungry, providing clean water, building housing, giving more money etc.

- **Questions of policy** – the proposition shows that there is a problem in the status quo (the way things are now) and requires a solution/plan/policy to take care of the problem.

(Often it involves a change in the United States Federal Government, or the USFG.)

Example: The United States should guarantee a free college education for all citizens.

****How can you tell if a topic is a policy topic?** Does the resolution contain the words, “should” or “would”? Ask yourself if 1) a change is needed for this proposition to happen or 2) if a new system would be needed to make this motion go into effect.

It is not always easy to differentiate between the three motions. The most important one to recognize is a question of **policy** because a policy proposition requires you to develop a plan to solve it. We’ll talk more about that later. (See sample resolutions for parli debate in Addendum 3.)

And sometimes a resolution will begin with “This house...” You will see resolutions that say, “This House believes...” or “This House would...” or “This House prefers...” In this case, the group doing the resolution is not set up – no actor has been named. It is then the Affirmative’s job to determine who the actor will be – the federal government, the Department of Education, NATO, the United Nations etc.

Example: This house believes that endangered species should be protected.

You can see how important it is to decide who the HOUSE is. If you choose the federal government, you have one topic to debate, but if you choose the United Nations, you have now made the resolution into an international topic. It can change everything!

What is the style of this type of debate?

This debate is more conversational and less confrontational. Wit (humor) in moderation is **encouraged**. Speakers should show more personality and flair. It is also slower paced than some kinds of debate. Even though it is more casual in style, speakers still need good delivery techniques. A poor delivery can wipe out all the good arguments that you are going to be making. You will learn more about good delivery techniques in a later chapter.



What is the format for this debate?

A parliamentary debate round lasts for a total of 40 minutes – 31 minutes for constructive speeches and 9 minutes for rebuttals.

Constructive speeches come first – During constructives, the teams present their arguments and lay out their cases. All arguments for both sides **MUST** be presented during the constructive speeches. No NEW arguments are allowed during rebuttals. There is **NO** prep time between speeches. Each speaker must be up to speak within 20 seconds of the person who spoke before. This is true for both constructive AND rebuttal speeches

First proposition (or Affirmation or Government) speech	7 minutes
First opposition (or Negation) speech	8 minutes
Second proposition (or Affirmation or Government) speech	8 minutes
Second opposition (or Negation) speech	8 minutes



Rebuttal speeches come last – The negation goes first in rebuttals. This means that the NEG has two speeches in a row: the last constructive and the first rebuttal. This is known as “the negative block.”

Opposition (Negation) rebuttal	4 minutes – <u>Given by the first opposition speaker</u>
Proposition (Affirmation) rebuttal	5 minutes – <u>Given by the first proposition speaker</u>

Novice teams have different times. Constructives are 5 minutes each and rebuttals are 3 minutes.

As you begin debating, the member of your team who is most confident at rebuttals should be the one to speak twice. Therefore, the most confident speaker should be the first Affirmation or first Negation speaker. Later, you can make strategic changes as you discover each other’s strengths and weaknesses.



What happens during your preparation time?

Once your team learns what the proposition for each debate will be, you will have 20 minutes to prepare if you are Junior Varsity or Varsity. Novice teams get 30 minutes to prep. And believe me, those minutes of prep will seem like a REAL WORKOUT – teams must use EVERY minute! During this time, you will sometimes be working by yourself and sometimes you will work with your partner. **BOTH partners must work equally hard to get done on time.** Just like a married couple, you will learn how you work best together and how you can

divide up the jobs you need to get done. You will get better at this the more you debate. At the end of your 20 minutes, you will need to have your general case planned. You will need to know the arguments you will present. In short, you will need to be ready to go into battle with the other team. In chapter 4, you will learn how to effectively use those 20 minutes of time.

Can you ask questions during a parli debate?

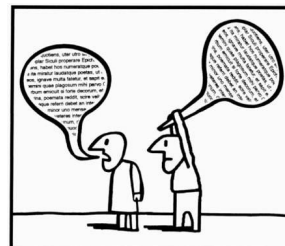


Yes, the other team can ask questions of the person who is speaking during constructive speeches – these are Points of Information (POIs) You can use these to get information you missed or to show a weakness in the speaker’s case. At some tournaments, you can also ask POCs or Points of Clarification. This is where you ask for a point or contention you didn’t hear or didn’t understand.

If you are the speaker, you can choose to answer a POI, but if it is a POC, you MUST answer it.. Debaters should try to ask at least one question and to answer one question. Judges like to see debaters do this. You will learn more about doing effective POIs and POCs in a subsequent chapter.

What is proper etiquette during a debate?

Here's what to remember: this is POLITE argumentation – not a knock-down-drag-out fight. You must always be respectful of the other team. You should never be pushy or talk down to the other team. And remember, you can communicate all kinds of things with non-verbal communication – so be careful to never roll your eyes, laugh, or make faces. That is VERY bad behavior.



You can talk to your partner during the other team's speeches, but it must be done very quietly. You must whisper and you must keep it brief.

You may hear some KNOCKING – Students will sometimes knock on their desk if they think their partner made a good point. Also, at the end of a rebuttal speech, you might give a knock on the desk for the other team if you were impressed with their debate performance. But don't go overboard with the knocking – it should be subtly done..

How About Debating at a Tournament?

When you go to a tournament, you will debate against teams from other schools. In the actual debate room, it will only be your team, the other team, and a judge. There are usually no spectators. Your first tournament will be a little scary, but you will be fine. And you don't have to worry – all the details about going to your first tournament – what to wear, what to bring, how it works – are found in Chapter 17. Your coach will go over all these things with you very carefully before you head off for your first big competition.

There are also online tournaments that happen via Zoom. Chapter 18 gives you more information on doing Zoom debates. In the meantime, you need to start learning more about this thing called parliamentary debate!

Chapter 2

Follow the Boy Scout Motto: Be Prepared

It's at this point that most students begin to wonder, "How can I do this? I don't know enough about current events. Even if I studied day and night, I still wouldn't know enough to do parli debate." But honestly, you can do a good job of preparing yourself for parli debate! Here are some pointers for getting prepared for the unexpected.



1. **Come to all the meetings and workshops.** That's where you will learn about parli debate. Think about it – you would never want to go to a semester final without having gone to the class first. And you would never attempt to play a competitive sport without learning the rules. The same holds true in debate – you want to go to all the sessions where you can learn everything you can!
2. **Watch the news or read the newspaper.** – If you commit each night to watching a 15 minute news show or reading the national and international section of the newspaper, you'll be quite prepared for parliamentary debate. Reading a weekly news magazine like Time, US News, or This Week can also provide you with a good solid grounding in current events. And I know what some of you are saying – I don't have TIME to do this. Many debaters listen to short news podcasts as they drive to school – consider The Flyover, The Daily or Up First.
3. **Check some of the pro and con websites to read about the topics on which the US and the world are currently focusing.** There are many sites that have pro and con discussions on current topics. Some of our favorites are procon.org and U.S. New's Debate Club.
4. **During preparation, think about what you already know on the subject** – what you learn in a class, what you hear on TV, what you read in books – all of that may be helpful. You are a great resource for information, so use your own knowledge
5. **During preparation, you can access the Internet.** A few pieces of key information can really make your arguments stronger. But don't forget, under NPD rules, logic and reasoning are the most important elements in parliamentary debate and they are weighed equally with cited evidence.
6. **If things get really tough, a LAST resort is ChatGPT or other AI-generated sites.**
While we absolutely prefer you to use your own brain, getting some arguments from ChatGPT can sometimes jump start your preparation and help you when you are in a real bind. But here's our cautionary note – **don't get dependent on ChatGPT**. It isn't always reliable and it often contains misinformation. And you can't use evidence from ChatGPT during a debate. You must go to the source ChatGPT cites. Some students just try writing down word-for-word the arguments presented in ChatGPT on paper, but judges are getting very savvy at recognizing when a student does this. And they can give you the loss if you do this. Instead write down tag lines for a couple of arguments and no more.
7. **Save any notes from previous debates.** You may find you get a similar topic at another debate tournament and using previous notes will save you valuable prep time.
8. **Practice doing lots of parliamentary debates,** and each time you do a practice debate, do it on a different topic. There's a reason for the old adage, "Practice makes perfect." Each time you do a practice debate, you are doing advance preparation on a topic you might encounter during competition AND you're practicing the debate skills you will need in competition.



Chapter 3

The Whole Enchilada (Or What Every Debate Speech Needs)

Every speech – both for the Affirmation and the Negation – must contain several basic elements. You must present these elements in the correct order so that your speech is organized and easy to follow.



PROVIDE YOUR NAME AND AN OFF-TIME ROADMAP

Before you start your speech time, each team member should give the judge their name and a roadmap of where the speech will go during the next few minutes. The roadmap is like providing a preview or outline of what you will cover in the speech. This helps the judge write notes and understand what is being said. These roadmaps are called “off-time roadmaps” meaning they are given BEFORE your official time begins. Even though it is not an official part of your speech, remember it is the FIRST TIME THE JUDGE HEARS FROM YOU so the off-time road map should still be delivered clearly, slowly, and professionally. Roadmaps should be short and should not include any contentions or information. The roadmaps will differ depending on which speaker you are: Here are some suggestions for giving a roadmap:



Example for 1 AFF – I am Nora S., and I am the first Affirmation speaker today. Let me provide an off-time roadmap of where I will go during the next few minutes. I will first frame the debate by discussing the type of resolution before us, providing a judging criteria, and giving the definition of terms. After framing the debate, I will move to the Affirmation case.

Example for 1 NEG – Let me introduce myself – my name is Sharva B, and I will be the 1st Negation speaker. Here is an off-time outline of the main areas I will touch on during the next 8 minutes: 1. my team’s problem with how the Affirmation framed the debate, 2. the Negation’s case, and finally 3. the Negation’s attack on the Affirmation’s case.

Example for 2 AFF – I am Logan A, the 2nd Affirmation speaker in today’s debate. I will cover several areas in my speech: first, I will address the Negation’s concern over the definitions, then, I will focus on the weaknesses in the Negation’s case, and finally, I will rebuild our Affirmative contentions.

Example for 2 NEG – I am the last constructive speaker today; my name is Moksh S. During this last constructive speech, I will discuss in this order the following areas: our continued problems with the Affirmative’s definitions, the rebuilding of the Negative case, and finally the weaknesses with the Affirmation contentions.



HAVE A QUICK INTRODUCTION AND THEN STATE THE PROPOSITION

After the off-time road map, you should pause for a moment, and then begin your official constructive. Begin your speech with an introduction (just a line or two) that catches the attention of the judge. It should be **VERY** short – 10 – 15 seconds. You need to save your time for

more important things. After your opening sentences, you must state the proposition EXACTLY as it was written.

Example:

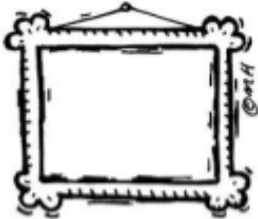
The United States of America guarantees an education to every child, but does that mean that children should be guaranteed a college education? That's the question we will debate today. As the Affirmation, we support the proposition that the United States should guarantee a free 4-year college to all children in the U.S.

Even though Intros have to be short, introductions still need to be GOOD. Real estate agents say that people usually decide whether to buy a house during the first 20 seconds after they enter a home – it's based on the initial feel they have for the house. The same is true of the Introduction of a speech. A judge will be predisposed to like or dislike you based on the first few words you speak. SO those words need to be smooth, confident, direct and effective. Those first words should NOT include "Well," "OK," and "All right." A quick quote, story, reference to a current event etc. can all open your speech effectively. (See Addendum 4 for more on Introductions.)

Step 3

FRAME THE DEBATE (AKA Interpreting the Motion)

In Step 3, you will need to frame the debate. When a house is built, the frame goes up first – it



establishes the footprint of the house, how big it will be, and where the builder is likely to go with it. A debate frame works the same way -- it sets the parameters of the debate on a particular topic. "Framing the debate" helps structure what kind of resolution we have, how it can best be judged, how the key terms in the resolution are defined, and if needed a historical explanation of parts of the motion. The Affirmation has the job of initially framing the debate. However, the Negation can disagree with any of the framing set up by

the Affirmation. Here is what the Affirmation must include when framing the debate:

The Affirmation first states whether it is a fact, value, or policy debate and, as such, what your team will need to prove. Here's what you say:

- It is a **fact** proposition, so the Affirmation will prove this statement of fact to be true.
- This is a **value** proposition, and the Affirmation will prove that this value, when weighed against another, is more valuable.
- This resolution is a **policy** resolution, and as such, the Affirmation will show why a policy change is necessary and suggest a plan to do it.

When it is the Negative's turn to frame the debate, they should either agree with this or state that they believe it is another kind of resolution. "We believe this is a policy debate, not a fact debate and that is very important because a policy debate requires a plan which the AFF did not provide!"

Next **the Affirmative team provides the judging criteria for this debate**. AFF should suggest to the judge how he/she should choose which team wins the debate. You can do this by telling him/her the judging criteria you believe should be used when judging who is the winner. Some teams will refer to

this as the ***weighing mechanism*** – in other words, what should the judge use to “weigh” who wins the debate. Here are the most common judging criteria:

- **net benefits** -- which team has the most benefits at the end of the debate
- **greatest impacts** -- which team will end up saving the most lives or saving the most money or having the most impact on people
- **preponderance of evidence** -- whose case was based on the most and best facts
- **cost-benefit** -- at the end of the debate, who has the most benefits for the lowest cost
- **utilitarianism** – who produces the greatest good for the most people
- **moral imperative** – we have a moral responsibility or obligation to do this. It is extremely important and is the right thing to do morally. Factors like cost should not make the decision.

Again, when the first Negation goes to frame the debate, they can either accept the judging criteria/weighing mechanism or choose one they feel is better and explain to the judge why.

The Affirmation will also need to define any key terms in the resolution. It is the AFF’s job to make sure that everyone (the other side and the judge) understands how you are thinking about the most important words in the resolution. Imagine if one team is thinking of “fruit” as “apples” and other is thinking of it as “oranges;” then you aren’t talking about the same thing, and you won’t have a good debate. It is the Affirmation’s job to **give a FAIR definition of any key words in the resolution**, so the Negation knows what you mean and so both teams are debating the same thing. If the definitions provided are too narrow, too biased, or too off-the-topic, the Negative should offer better ones.

Finally, **the AFF may need to discuss the history or meaning of the subject of the motion so that the judge understands.** Let’s say your motion involves “stiffer boat laws on quagga mussels.” You may want to take a moment to discuss what the current laws for quagga mussels are or a quick look back at what has happened to date. The judge may not be familiar with quagga mussels, and thus, this quick information provides important information to help them judge the debate. The judge will appreciate the SHORT lesson.

Take a look at the example below to see all of these elements used as the speaker frames the debate.

EXAMPLE:

Name type of proposition	<i>This proposition is a policy proposition, which means that we of the Affirmation will need to give you reasons why a new policy is necessary and present a plan to achieve it.</i>
Set the judging criteria	<i>As you listen to the debate, we believe that you need to judge the teams on which team offers the greatest net benefits – in other words, which team’s case can guarantee more advantages.</i>
Define key terms	<i>We would define these key terms – “free” as “no cost to the child or his family” and “children” as “all children born in the U.S. or children who have achieved citizenship. We believe all other terms need no definition.</i>

HINT – You will need to come back to the judging criteria throughout the debate, especially during the rebuttals. And don't forget – it isn't enough to SAY you have more benefits. You need to prove it. It isn't enough to say you have more evidence; you need to show the judge where this is true!



MAKE YOUR CASE

Step 4 makes up the bulk of your speech; it's here where you will present your major claims (AKA arguments/harms/contentions/benefits.) You will want to make sure that all arguments you offer are complete; they **MUST** contain 3 elements

1. you **state your claim/argument**,
2. you **include the examples and evidence – then, you provide the warrant, which tells the judge why the statement is true.** The warrant is the reasoning that connects a claim to its example, demonstrating the logical basis of an argument
3. you **show its IMPACT on the world** – in other words why your argument **MATTERS!**

Also, it will not be enough simply to ramble on—you **MUST** be organized and you must clearly and simply introduce each point. Fortunately, this is why you have prepared an outline on your flow sheet or notes page. You might say something like this:

I will present three major problems with our higher education system today. First, the cost of higher education puts it out of reach for most young Americans.....Subpoint A The average cost of a year of college tuition is \$15,000 in California. The impact is that many low income students will be prevented from attending college!

(You will learn more in Chapter 5 about how to structure each argument.) In short, the first AFF speech is the most planned of all the speeches. The rest of the speakers will tailor their speeches to fit what the speakers before them have argued. In this way, we get **DIRECT CLASH** in the debate.



ATTACK THE OPPOSITION'S CASE



One of the most important jobs that team members will have is to attack and weaken the arguments presented by the opponents. (The First Affirmative is the only speaker who will not do this during Constructives since that speech is the first.) In order to attack well, debaters **MUST** always take notes on what the other side is saying. They must also be jotting down what they plan to say in response to each argument they hear.

The biggest mistake a debater can make is to attack by simply repeating the arguments his/her partner first made. The judge doesn't need to hear the same arguments again – instead the judge wants to hear how your team will respond to the attacks the other side just made. If you simply repeat your arguments, you are not engaging with the other side; you are not **CLASHING**. Imagine a sports team that never interacted with the other side – there would be no game! To respond to the arguments presented by the other team is to “**extend**” your arguments. You will learn how to do this in later chapters. And remember, you need to be organized when you

attack the opposition's case. You need to attack arguments in the same order that they were presented.

STEP 6

DELIVER THE CONCLUSION

At the end of your speech, you should offer a convincing, persuasive, and SHORT conclusion that summarizes the key points of your case and drives home your message to the judge. BE strong and confident – don't just trail off... Tell the judge to vote for your team!



EXAMPLE:

The Affirmation has shown you that college is too costly for the majority of students, that this burden hits low income families the hardest, and that it leaves students paying off huge loans for a long time. We have presented a plan that makes college affordable for ALL who want it. A vote for the Affirmation is the BEST answer for our young people.

**

This chapter has just given you an overview of the elements that go into parliamentary speeches. In the chapters coming up, we will delve into many of the parts of a parliamentary speech in much more detail, showing you how to prepare your speech during your 20 minutes of prep time, how to frame the debate, how to structure good arguments, how to attack your opponent's arguments, how to weaken evidence used by your opponents, how to write a plan, how to attack a plan, and how to deliver the entire speech. I guess you can tell – there is still a lot to learn to become a good parliamentary debater! So let's get started!



Chapter 4

On Your Mark, Get Set, GO!

Using your Prep Time



So now you know what generally goes into an Affirmative or Negative case. But you're probably asking yourself, "How do I plan a whole case in just a few minutes – you told me I only have 20 minutes of prep time!" Well, that's where learning how to use that 20 minutes (or 30 minutes, if you are a Novice team) to your full advantage becomes important! The winning teams use every minute to build the best case they can.



So let's learn how to use your prep – time's a tickin'! First and foremost, set a timer on your watch or computer so you can watch your time and know how much remains.

First, 2 minutes -- you and your partner will discuss the resolution and what it means. You will need to get in your mind the subject that you are debating and what it means if you are for or against the resolution. You will quickly begin to frame the debate – as a team, you will decide:

- is it a fact, value, or policy motion – Write what you decide in your notes
- what judging criteria you want to use – Write that in your notes as well
- what are the key terms in this resolution and how will you define them. Write the definitions in abbreviated form in your notes.

Tick tock -- Two minutes are now gone.....

Next 12 minutes -- Build your case. ***Create the claims you will make***, as we learned in the last chapter. You should see if either of you knows anything about this topic. Then, you and your partner will look on the Internet and see if you can find some articles that pertain to the topic. Search YOUR SIDE of the topic. For instance if the topic is **"The USFG should ban online sports betting"** and you are negative, put in as a search "Online sports betting is good." You will then get articles that support the position you have been asked to take in the debate. Don't put in a search for "Sports betting" because that is too general and won't get you what you need. As you research, you will start to see possible contentions that support your side of the debate. Discuss the possible contention/argument with your partner and decide whether to use it. As you find a good contention that you want to use, you will **BOTH** write it down on your note paper and label it as argument #1 or argument #2. Be sure to leave room between contentions in your notes to add the supportive facts.

Next you need to ***come up with your warrants or evidence and ideas that support your claim***. SO continue your research. As you find a piece of evidence to support it, you will BOTH write it down in the space you have left open on your notes. Remember, as you choose evidence, write down the cite references. Also don't forget to think about examples from your own life, things you learned in history or science class, analogies that you can use as evidence. Parli is more about logic and

reasoning than tons of evidence. Pick your own brains for what you know. For example, if you are negative on banning sports betting, maybe one of the arguments you come up with is that “legal sports betting is a voluntary and positive form of entertainment.” Now check your own brain for ideas – You realize you can compare it to entertainments like going to the movies or out to dinner. That’s EVIDENCE! You realize that sports betting would add a way to follow a sport you already love even more. That’s EVIDENCE! You think about football pools and how they could be considered a form of betting. And you realize that when your family was in a football pool, it made the season more fun. That’s EVIDENCE! All these examples come from FROM WHAT YOU ALREADY KNOW and are legitimate forms of evidence in parliamentary debate, so use them as you flesh out your argument and create your warrants.

Let’s take a look at how that argument is now fleshed out in your notes. Your warrants include both personal information and a fact you gleaned from your research! And notice how you abbreviate to save you time.

Sports betting is a voluntary and positive form of entertainment.

- a. Like going to dinner/a show
- b. Makes you enjoy sports more. My family – football pools
- c. “Overwhelmingly, 93% of online sports bettors say it’s fun and exciting and 83% say it makes them more interested in watching the games (85%)” (St. Boneventure University and Siena College Research Institute study, Feb, 5, 2024)

And as you research, don’t forget to look for the IMPACTS of your contention. That is the last, but most important part of EVERY contention. What is the impact or effect of this argument in cost, in lives, in improvement of conditions? **Every contention must contain the impact!** Impacts can include magnitude (how big a problem, how many are affected by it); the scope (how far-reaching is the impact); probability (how likely it can be done) ; or timeframe (the urgency of doing something now)

As time progresses, you should slowly see your case coming together in your notes. (These notes are called a flow sheet. You will learn more about flow sheets in Chapter 8.) Make sure your notes are clear and readable. Why? Well, once you are in the room where you will debate, you can only use your handwritten notes!

And don’t forget – if you are doing a policy topic, you must save time to develop a plan. If you don’t have a plan, you lose the debate!

Tick tock -- Fifteen minutes are now gone....

For 3 minutes, speculate (guess) what arguments the other side may bring up and figure out what your response would be if they do. In other words, you should prepare for the punches that will be thrown by the other team. You will be ready with your answers/responses to the other side’s arguments. Don’t forget the old proverb, “Forewarned is forearmed.”



Tick tock -- Eighteen minutes are now gone....

Last 2 minutes -- Always save a few minutes at the end for looking over your material and memorizing it. Get yourself into the right frame of mind. And if you get to your debate round and the judge isn't there yet, don't just sit there. You and your partner have just been given extra time --- use it to refine your case or continue to find evidence.

Time's Up!



And that's it – your time is up! Yep, 20 minutes gone! It will seem like it sped by, but as you do it more, you will get better and better at using your prep time. It is another one of those things that just takes practice.

Of course, as you and your partner work together, how you use your time will evolve. There are no hard and fast rules with how you use your 20 minutes – just make sure you don't waste any of it.

What if, horror of horrors, we can't find anything on the topic?

First thing to remember is DO NOT PANIC! This is where you and your partner use your brains. Also remember that in novice and junior varsity debate, TEAM preparation is allowed. This means that you can work with anyone on our team – not just your partner. Talking with other teams from your school may help you if you don't know enough about the topic. When you have reached the Varsity level, you will no longer be allowed to do team preparation. You will go to a special prep room where you and your partner work together with no outside help. Finally, there is ChatGPT. Maybe it will give you an idea for some contentions. BUT please, don't begin to use it all the time. As we have said before, ChatGPT makes mistakes AND you cannot cite any evidence from ChatGPT in the debate – you would still need to go to the original source and see if the evidence is correct. If you always turn to ChatGPT first, you won't grow as a debater – you will become lazy and sloppy!



Do you really have to use evidence?

Judges are told to consider logic and reasoning the most when making a decision about who wins a parliamentary debate. However, reality shows that judges like evidence. Let's face it – every argument is better if it is backed up with evidence. And the better evidence you present, the better the argument. So always try to have some good evidence. Think how much more powerful it sounds to say "According to Feeding America, in 2026, 1 in 5 U.S. children lacks enough food" rather than "Many kids are going hungry in the U.S." Trust me, judges notice the teams that use evidence.

And as you gather that evidence, both you and your partner should WRITE IT DOWN IN YOUR NOTES and write down the CITE reference too. (Remember, you can't use the books, laptop etc. in your debate – you can only use your notes on the flow sheet.)

Chapter 5

If You Build It, They Will Come – Constructing Effective Contentions

It is true for both the Affirmation and Negation that at least part of your case will be composed of arguments (also called contentions or harms) that you present to prove your position.

Well-constructed arguments are essential! You need at least three parts in every argument.

One – You must state your argument or claim clearly, concisely, and as a statement – not a question. Always number it – “Our first contention is....” Later in the debate, you can state your claim as a “tagline.” This is a shortened summary of the claim.



Two – You must provide your warrant and evidence. As you learned in the last chapter, **the warrant tells the judge why the statement is true**. Here’s where you put in the reasoning and evidence to support it. And you need to explain or interpret the evidence so the judge understands how it relates to your contention. Sometimes, an argument will be complex, and you will need to structure it by dividing it into subpoints that you number (First subpoint A etc.). Always cite your source if you have one.

Three – You must show the impact of this argument as it relates to the real world.

Here are the three BIG mechanisms used to show impact:

1. Magnitude – how BIG is your impact – we can save many lives, we can save money, we can enhance a national or world condition like pollution or hunger
2. Probability – We can guarantee it will happen; the status quo can’t guarantee this
3. Timeframe – We can make it happen more quickly than the status quo

Let’s take a look at this in action. Let’s say we are debating the topic: *Cell phones are bad for teens*. Here is how you might structure an argument to support this proposition.

State argument/claim:	Our first contention is cell phones lead to risky behaviors in teens. (Note: Keep the claim simple and make it a statement). Later you can abbreviate it to “Risky behaviors.” This is called a “tag”
Provide the warrant & evidence:	A. Leads to bad pedestrian behavior – 45% more likely to have an accident when walking while talking on cell (Study U. of Alabama ’08) B. Used for cyber bullying – 1/3 kids say they have been victimized – KidsHealth.org
Show the Impact:	Magnitude: Less injuries, fewer deaths, and better self-esteem will result

A **well-constructed argument** is an argument that sounds much stronger to the judge, and to be honest, it is more difficult to defeat. Well-constructed arguments also allow your judge to follow the debate more easily – it leads to a more organized debate. Three well-constructed arguments is a good number to aim for. That makes for a nice solid case.

Chapter 6

Tear Down that Wall – Effectively Attacking Arguments

As your opponents present their arguments, you have to plan how you will destroy them. You have to look at what they have said and figure out what you can say to poke holes in each point. And then you have to deliver your attacks in a clear, organized manner. It's easy if you just follow the pattern. Try this 4-step refutation method.

The opposition said ...	summarize what the opposition said <u>very briefly</u> – if you spend too long on this, you are just reinforcing the other's side argument and letting the judge hear all about it again.
But	tell them that what the opposition said isn't accurate, or significant, or true etc. – in other words, explain what is wrong with the analysis of the opposition
Because.....	explain WHY it isn't accurate etc. – present your logic and evidence to show WHY it isn't correct – sometimes you will have MORE than one reason for why it isn't accurate. In that case, you may have to divide your attack into subpoints. If the other side had subpoints, you will need to attack each subpoint separately. And don't forget to attack the impact!
Therefore.....	draw the conclusion – show the judge how this weakens your opponent's case and how it supports your position in the debate.

What's important about the pattern above is that it is organized and clear. Most judges appreciate hearing a well-constructed attack. Think about it from the judge's point of view – which team would you vote for? One team is organized, their arguments are clearly stated, they present evidence in an understandable way, and they precisely tell you why each attack is important to the resolution being debated. The other team jumps all over, doesn't succinctly state their points, doesn't number their sub-points so you can't tell when they have started a new piece of analysis, and never tells why their attack is important to the resolution. The decision is clear!

On the next page, see this strategy in action. We will use it with the argument on cell phones and see how it might be handled. Remember, this is just a suggestion -- there are many ways to attack a point.

The opposition said....	that cells phones lead teens to risky behaviors, and as their subpoint they say, it often happens while walking and talking on the phone.
But.....	we would argue this: risky behaviors are an accepted part of being a teenager and those risky behaviors will continue even if teens don't have cell phones.
Because.....	Teens are always involved in risky behavior, and as a society we have accepted that risk as part of the teen years and permitted them to do it. A. They are allowed to drive though it increases their accidents. They are allowed to play football though it increases their risk for injury B. They are allowed to use the computer though it can cause cumulative Injuries like carpal tunnel
And	Subpoint B on cyberbullying can't be solved through banning cell phone use by teens.
Because.....	kids will be bullied regardless of the cell phone. 56% of students say they have personally felt some sort of bullying at school. The bullying will not stop just because cell phones aren't there.
Therefore.....	we would argue that the Affirmation's claim that cell phones are bad because they lead to risky behavior isn't significant. And furthermore, many of those risky behaviors aren't inherent to the cell phone and will continue with or without the cell phone.

Chapter 7

It All Boils Down to the Evidence – Or Does It?

In parliamentary debate, we don't use a lot of evidence. There isn't time in 20 minutes to do the kind of research that yields well-documented evidence on each point presented. But EVERY team should strive to have some evidence in their case, and they should cite the source of that evidence when they present it. It adds power and credibility to your team, and the citation is required. Please, don't become one of those teams who makes up their evidence!



My Evidence is Better than Yours!



Sometimes a debate can become a “battle of evidence.” One team presents a great piece of evidence and the opposition knows they need to make that evidence seem less important or they will lose the point. Sometimes each team will have a piece of evidence on a key point, and one piece of evidence will seem to contradict the other piece of evidence. Each team knows

they need to make their evidence seem better than the evidence presented by their opponents. The question is, “How do you discredit the evidence presented by the other side, so that the judge gives you the argument?” Here are some strategies to use:

1. **Challenge the date of your opponent's evidence.**

If your opponents have evidence that is older and more outdated than your evidence, point it out to the judge. When it comes to evidence, newer is BETTER.

2. **Challenge your opponent's source.**

If your opponents have taken their information from a weak source, and you know your source is good, then argue this with the judge.

Examples of weak sources include:

- **blogs** -- they are just opinions for the most part
- **ChatGPT** – we already mentioned that you can't cite directly from Chat GPT in parliamentary debate – if ChatGPT lists a source, you must go to that source and get the evidence from there.
- **biased groups** (they have an agenda) – for instance, did you know the CATO Institute is a conservative think tank? They may not be an unbiased source even though their name makes it sound like that. Political action groups, election groups, and special interest groups may put out material that someone quotes, but this material should be discounted because the source is BIASED.
- **a source where the other side doesn't give their credentials** – Just because someone says a name, it doesn't mean that person is an expert on that subject. Be especially



careful of an elected official being quoted. First, that politician is biased and has his/her own agenda, and second, that elected official may not have any expertise on the information he/she is providing.

- **a group that has been discredited recently** – for instance, think of Rolling Stones magazine which published a report on a rape case at the University of Virginia. They later had to retract what they had written because they had not fact checked the story and there were inconsistencies in their source's recollections. You should be asking whether Rolling Stone has used this sloppy reporting on ALL their stories. Or think of Brian Williams, the NBC newscaster, who got called on the carpet for making up a story about his helicopter being shot down. Does Brian play loose with the other facts when he reports? You can cast doubt on the credibility of the source.

3. Challenge the evidence or statistic itself.

Remember evidence may sound important, but on closer analysis, it may have a weakness you can attack. Listen and analyze the evidence you are hearing – don't just accept the statistic or fact as valid. Remember statistics especially can be misleading. Here are some ways to weaken the evidence:

- **The evidence isn't SIGNIFICANT** -- For example, let's say the Affirmative uses the statistic that 20,000 children are injured in sledding accidents each year. That sounds pretty significant until you realize that that number really only represents .03% of US children. Or until you realize that 300,000 kids are injured riding bicycles each year. Now the statistic doesn't sound so impressive; it isn't that significant. And if you are smart, you will attack the evidence based on SIGNIFICANCE.
- **The evidence doesn't apply to what you are discussing** -- Let's say you were debating whether a suicide barrier on the Golden Gate Bridge is a good idea. The other team brings up a statistic that "only 1 person jumped off a bridge in Nebraska last year." You need to tell the other team, "We aren't discussing Nebraska – we are discussing the Golden Gate Bridge. That evidence has no bearing on this debate!"
- **The evidence is taken out of context** -- The team quotes an expert as saying, "Those drones are a liability." You should be asking, "What drones was that person speaking about? Can we see more of the quote? The expert may be speaking just about domestic drones, and you are debating military drones. You always need to see more than a single sentence to know the true context of the evidence.
- **The evidence really is just an opinion that SOUNDS like a fact** -- A politician can say, "Bacon is a serious health risk." But that politician is probably just stating his opinion. Has he researched the subject? Is he considered an expert on the subject? Just because someone well-known makes a statement about a topic doesn't mean that statement is fact. This gets back to the point about whether the source is really knowledgeable on the topic.

SO LISTEN TO THE EVIDENCE CAREFULLY. Ask your opponent Points of Information and Clarification to learn more about the evidence. Then, you can attack the evidence itself later in your speech.

4. Challenge the conclusion they are drawing from the evidence – CAUSAL LINK

In other words, see if the evidence and the conclusion really have a causal link. Consider this: the AFF argues that requiring vaccinations will save lives. Then they bring up the following quote from the Centers for Disease Control: “From January 1 to February 6, 2015, 121 people from 17 states and Washington DC were reported to have measles.” When you look at the evidence, you can see that it has nothing to do with saving lives. The AFF has drawn a conclusion that isn’t supported by the evidence they present. There is NO CAUSAL LINK set up showing that vaccinations will save lives. And there is no causal link in this evidence between getting the measles and eventually dying from the measles. Call the other team out on this.

5. Challenge that their evidence is really UNIQUE to the topic they are discussing --

Sometimes, evidence actually applies to a much broader subject area. Look at this argument presented by one team:

Cell phones lead to distracted driving. According to the NHTSA, over 3,331 people were killed and over 387, 000 injured in motor vehicle accidents connected to distracted driving. That represents 10 percent of all fatal crashes and 17 percent of all accidents that caused injuries. Therefore, we can save 10 percent more lives if we prohibit cell phone use.

Can you see the problem with this argument and the evidence that supports it? The statistics they present on distracted driving are NOT unique just to cell phones! They deal with ALL kinds of distracted driving – dealing with the kids, cleaning up spilled food, dialing the phone, using the radio, putting on make-up etc. We have no idea how much of the distracted driving is because of cell phone use -- it could be anywhere from 1% to 9% of the distracted driving. So they can’t claim they will save 10% more lives by stopping cell phone use!

Here are a few more thoughts –

1. If it is a battle over whose evidence is right, then present another piece of evidence if you have one. As we all know, more is better!
2. Seriously, no debate should be won or lost on one piece of evidence. Point that out to the judge – “Look ,you have to decide which piece of evidence to believe on this argument. But this debate is so much more than this one argument and the debate shouldn’t hinge on just this piece of evidence. Look at all the other VOTING issues we have given you in this debate.”
3. If you suspect that the other team may have invented their evidence (horrors!), offer during your speech to let the judge and the other team examine your evidence at the end of the debate. That now puts the other team in the HOT SEAT to present their evidence. The judge probably won’t ask to see it, but in his mind, he is thinking, “That team has enough confidence in their evidence to show it to me. I believe them.” Our rules also say that you can ask to see a team’s evidence and source on their papers – quotes are to be written out in full with no ellipsis (...) on their notes. The citation must be there as well. Hint -- When you question a team’s evidence, always be polite and respectful of the other team.



Chapter 8

Go With the Flow – Taking Notes On Your Debate

During the debate, you need to take notes on what is said by both teams, and you need to take those notes FAST! In order to do this, you will want to learn a specialized form of note taking developed just for debating. This method is known as “flowing the debate.” In this method, you will write down your arguments and what the other side says about those arguments – you FLOW those arguments across the flow sheet. Here’s one method for flowing a debate:

It’s usually a good idea to get legal-sized paper (longer than regular 8 x 11) and turn it horizontally. Then divide the paper into 6 columns, labeling each column for a speech that will be given in the debate. Do the six columns on BOTH sides of the paper. Here’s what it should look like:

Resolution:					
1AC	1NC	2AC	2NC	NR	AR

In the first column, you will write down the Affirmation case as it is presented. (If you are the Affirmation, you and your partner can do this during your prep time once you decide on the points.) YOU NEED TO ABBREVIATE and YOU NEED TO LEAVE SPACE BETWEEN EACH POINT. As much as you can, you also need to write down facts, statistics, and sources. Even though you’re writing fast, you want it to be as legible and complete as possible. Your partner may need to read what you’ve written, and let’s face it, it can be embarrassing if you can’t read your own handwriting during your speech! If the AFF is presenting a plan, write it down as well.

In the second column, you will write down the NEGATION’S response to each item presented in the AFF’s case, and you write it RIGHT ACROSS FROM THE POINT IT RELATES TO. For the negation’s case (their own specific contentions, you will flip the paper over to the backside and write their case arguments in the second column. Again, leave space between each point. (See the sample.)

In the remaining speeches, you will continue to write the responses to each argument next to the argument to which they are related. In this way, you can see how an argument developed – what the argument was, what was said to break it down, and what was said to rebuild the argument etc.

If an argument is dropped, you will also want to mark this on your flow sheet. Sometimes teams draw a circle in the place where it was dropped or write DROP on the flow. (See the sample.) Finally in rebuttals, the key arguments – AKA the VOTING issues – need to be clearly listed or circled.

Does this format work for you? If not, you will want to develop your own style of flowing the debate. Some teams use multiple pieces of paper and put one argument on each piece. Other teams turn their paper vertically and don’t use as many columns. You and your partner will need to work on how to effectively take good notes.

Chapter 9

“Me Talk Pretty One Day” -- Delivering a Great Debate Speech

The arguments you present in a debate are important, and truth be told, they should be the most important factor in the judge’s decision. But let’s face it – HOW you deliver those arguments can sway the decision. A poor delivery can distract the judge from what is being said, or even worse, can cause him/her to stop listening. So good delivery is essential!

In parliamentary debate, you will use a bit more relaxed, conversational style. With only 20 minutes to prepare, you don’t have time to practice your speech in front of a mirror or memorize every word. So it will not be as polished as some speeches you might give. Here are some pointers to remember:

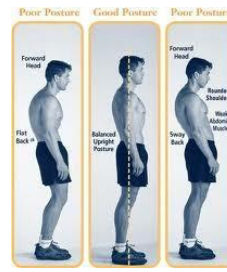
1. **GOOD DELIVERY STARTS FROM THE FIRST WORD YOU SPEAK AND ENDS WITH THE LAST!** Judges start making impressions from the moment you utter your first word. Lots of debaters rush through their off-time road map, thinking it doesn’t matter. Don’t fall into that trap. Even the road map should be delivered with polish and professionalism. AND that conclusion also shouldn’t be an after-thought. Don’t let it trail off as you head to sit down. Deliver it with style and with a strong voice. Don’t start to sit down until the speech is over!
2. **JUST SAY IT** – Sometimes debaters stumble as they try to figure out the best word to use. They want their speech to be as good as a written essay, but IT SIMPLY CAN’T BE! So don’t worry about finding the perfect word or using complex-compound sentences etc. – JUST SPIT IT OUT!
3. **SAY IT LIKE YOU MEAN IT**– You have been assigned a side in a debate, but there’s a good chance you don’t agree with that side. Nevertheless, you must make your judge BELIEVE that you support your team’s position 100%. You need to be passionate as you speak; you must be persuasive. If you hope to win this debate, you have to CONVINCE the judge of your position, not just with your case, but through your delivery. Bottom line: get excited and deliver an impassioned speech.
4. **USE YOUR VOICE LIKE AN INSTRUMENT.** An instrument has flexibility – you can make it go fast or slow, loud or soft, and at different pitches and rhythms. Your voice should be played just like an instrument – varying it to keep the audience interested and to emphasize the words you are saying.
 - Change up your speed – go faster when you are building to a key point, go slower when you want to summarize your point, and put a period after each word to REALLY make a point. THE. JUDGE. WILL. FEEL. THE. IMPACT. OF. THIS! Caution – In their desire not to run out of time, debaters sometimes fall into the trap of talking TOO FAST. If a debater goes so fast that the judge didn’t catch the argument, then it is as if the debater didn’t make the argument at all. Debaters should watch the faces of their judges – are they looking confused, irritated or bored? If so, try slowing down.



- Vary your volume – Sometimes you can hammer a point home by being loud. Sometimes you want to talk softly to make everyone lean in to hear what you are saying.
- Think about your pitch – if your voice gets high and squeaky when you get excited, you need to think about lowering your voice. Squeaky voices tend to come from your head; try speaking more from the chest to get richer, deeper tones. People (maybe your judge is one of them) often distrust those with squeaky, high voices.
- Emphasize KEY words – press just a little harder when you say key words – it is a clue to the listeners to pay attention to that word

5. **LET YOUR POSTURE AND EYE CONTACT ANNOUNCE YOUR CONFIDENCE –** even if you don't have any!

- Stand straight – don't lean on one leg. And don't while sitting is more difficult than standing and
- Don't rock back and forth
- Don't bend over and stare down at your notes. with the judge – if you avoid looking at the judge your notes, it looks like you have something to



sit!. Speaking speaking!

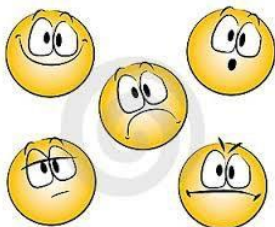
Make eye contact or look down at hide. It also affects

- your volume – your voice goes down and not out to the judge. You may be difficult to hear. If you talk to the ceiling, your volume goes up, hits the ceiling, and then comes down – it doesn't go out to the judge. It may make what you are saying inaudible. If you look at the judge and speak out towards the judge, it forces him/her to pay attention to you and what you are saying. Eye contact pulls your audience into your speech.
- Remember, you may be debating the other team, but you are persuading the judge to get their vote. While it is good to make eye contact with the other team at times, your primary focus needs to be on the judge.

6. **TRY SOME GESTURES --** Don't be afraid to gesture – your gestures can put in lots of expression to what you are saying. They can almost serve as silent punctuation to your arguments.

- A little gesticulating (waving arms dramatically) is a good thing – moving your arms aimlessly is not.
- Don't gesture with your pen or pencil – leave writing implements back at your desk
- Avoid nervous gestures – rattling change in your pocket, moving your hair out of your eyes, moving your head strangely. Yes, these are all things NERVOUS people do, and your judge will see them and register your nervousness, whether you want him/her to or not.
- Let your arms rest naturally at your sides when not gesturing – try this: roll your shoulders forward and then up to your ears. Now drop them – this should cause your arms to drop naturally to your sides, and that's where you want them to stay.

7. **WATCH NEGATIVE NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION –** Yep, you can speak



volumes WITHOUT EVER SAYING A WORD! Make sure when you speak that your face is animated and has expression. Try to look confident. But watch what your face says about the other team. If you are unhappy with the other team or think they made a bad argument, don't let your non-verbal communication reveal this. So don't roll your eyes, throw your head back in disbelief, shake your

head, or laugh. This is VERY unprofessional and you don't need to win this way. Keep your thoughts to yourself and off your face!

8. **LET YOUR PERSONALITY SHOW THROUGH** – You don't want to be a stick figure who is wooden, dry, and boring. Be yourself; don't rein yourself in. Let your personality show through. Be witty if that is who you generally are. A little humor never hurts.
9. **AND WHEN ALL ELSE FAILS, SMILE!** – A smile is friendly; it shows confidence. It connects you to your judge. And smiles don't cost a thing, so use them often – at the beginning, in the middle, and at the end of the speech.



Chapter 10

No One Told Me This Was My Job!

Each Team Member's Responsibilities

So far in this handbook, we have discussed parliamentary debate in rather GENERAL terms – now it's time to get SPECIFIC and talk about what each member of the team must do during their constructive speeches. Each member has slightly different responsibilities and must effectively accomplish them for the team to win the debate.

As we talk about each member's responsibilities, we will look at examples based on this topic:

Resolved: the USFG should significantly increase the use of alternate energy sources.

Also in Addendum 3 entitled 'What's A Speaker To Do,' you will find what you might think of as "Cheat Sheets." They summarize what is covered here – use them in your early debates as you get the hang of things.

First Affirmation (or Government) Constructive Speech

- Introduce yourself and give a roadmap– give your name clearly and then provide your "roadmap" or an outline of what you will cover in the next few minutes.
 - **Example:** *My name is Stella C, and I will be the first Affirmative speaker today. In the next few minutes, I will first frame the debate, and then I will provide several reasons why using alternate energy sources are a better solution for America.*
- Begin the timed part of your speech. Start with a couple of lines of Introduction that introduce your topic and then state the resolution –
 - **Example:** *Oil is becoming more and more expensive. Because of this and other reasons we will soon discuss, we of the affirmation believe that we should adopt the resolution that states: The USFG should significantly increase the use of alternate energy sources.*
- Third on the list is to frame your debate – tell what kind of a resolution it is (fact, value, or policy), what judging criteria should be applied to this debate (nets benefit, greatest impact, preponderance of evidence, utilitarianism or cost benefit), and give the definition of key terms.
 - **Example:** *This is a policy debate, and it will be our job to show you that the US needs to change the status quo. We believe this debate should be judged on a preponderance of evidence, and we will present overwhelming evidence to show this resolution needs adoption. We would now like to define the one key term in the resolution we're debating as follows: "alternate energy sources" will be "all energy sources other than oil and nuclear power."*

Note – when defining terms, you can use a dictionary, encyclopedia, or common knowledge to define the words. Being fair with the way you define them is important. Remember that your definitions should fulfill the INTENT of the motion – in other words, they should capture what the writer of the resolution really intended you to debate. And frankly, you don't want your definitions to be so strange or "off" that the whole debate deteriorates to a debate about your definitions.

- If the topic is not one that your judge may be familiar with, take a moment at this point to give a little history or background on it. Keep it short, but informative. Your judge will appreciate this!
- If you are debating a policy resolution, you will need a plan and advantages to the plan – it is at this point that you present your plan. (More on plans in a later chapter.)
- Present your Affirmation case. Give each argument /contention and the evidence that supports it. Most cases should have a minimum of three arguments or reasons for supporting the resolution.

Example: *Our first argument is that we are too dependent on oil from other countries. (After you stated your argument, you would give any information/evidence that you had that supported that argument. And last you will state the impact of your argument.)*

- End with the conclusion: You quickly summarize your key points and urge a vote for the Affirmation.



So here's the First Affirmation Checklist

- ☐ I have given a road map.
- ☐ I have given a short Introduction
- ☐ I have stated the resolution.
- ☐ I have framed the debate
 - ☐ I told what kind of resolution it was
 - ☐ I gave a judging criteria
 - ☐ I defined the KEY terms
- ☐ I gave some history or background if necessary
- ☐ If it is a policy debate, I have provided a plan
- ☐ I have claimed 2 – 3 contentions
- ☐ I have given a conclusion

First Negation (or Negative) Constructive Speech

Give your name and provide an off-time “roadmap” (an outline) of what you will cover in the next few minutes.



Example: *Hello, my name is Arnav L. and I will be the first Negative. In the next few minutes, I will: 1) discuss some concerns we have with how the AFF framed of the debate, 2) present the Negative case, and 3) return to the Affirmation’s case and show why it is flawed. Turning first to the Affirmative’s framing of the debate....*

- Give an Introduction of only a couple of sentences that introduces your topic and states that you see flaws in the proposition’s case –

Example: *While “exploring alternative energy sources” may presently seem like the PC thing to do, developing these sources will be extremely expensive. It is for this reason and others, we stand opposed to the resolution.*

- Agree or disagree with the AFF’s framing of the debate – with their labeling of the proposition, with the judging criteria they want the judge to use, and/or with the definitions. Sometimes you have no problem with the way they framed the debate. If that is the case, say so. But you may have some issues with the framing. Here is an example of what you might say if you didn’t like either the labeling of the proposition or the judging criteria suggested by the Affirmative

Example: *The Affirmative told you this is a policy debate, and we are in agreement on this. However, they want the judging criteria to be preponderance of evidence. We believe that evidence can always be found to support an argument, and we prefer that the judge use net benefits. In other words, judge us on the number and quality of the benefits we secure for the American people.*

The most common concern with the framing of the debate is how the Affirmation defined the terms. Attack them if you feel their definitions don’t reflect the purpose or INTENT of the resolution. In other words, you tell the judge that if you were to debate with their definition of terms as provided by the AFF, you wouldn’t really be debating what the resolution intended. This is a TOPICALITY argument – more on that in a later chapter. If you feel the AFF only talked about one part of the proposition and they need to talk about the entire topic, then attack them. In our example above the Affirmation excluded nuclear power as an alternative energy source.” You might want to argue this.



Example: *We disagree with the Affirmation’s definition of alternative energy sources. They exempted “nuclear power” from their definition. Clearly, the majority of our power comes from oil, making nuclear power technology clearly an “alternate” energy source. The AFF has purposefully kept it out of the definition because nuclear power is both costly and detrimental, as we will show you later. So we need to redefine alternate energy sources to include nuclear power, and it is on that definition that the Negation will debate.*

- Present the Negation's case – Each Negative team should have developed at least 2 – 3 arguments that support the negative position. Presenting the Negative case early in your speech ensures that you have your arguments presented early in the event you were to run out of time. You want the arguments you choose to be unique to the Negative side.

Example: *Now let's turn to the Negation's two contentions. Number #1 – Developing alternate energy sources will cost far too much money – money that could be better spent on other things.*

Of course, some of your Negative case arguments may apply to the Affirmative arguments. If you can use them to break down AFF arguments, you can let the judge know that you will be referring to this argument again later in the debate. For instance, you might say, "Now remember this analysis because I will refer to it later when refuting the Affirmation case." Other teams also refer to this as "cross applying a point" – This is essentially where you use previous information or arguments to attack a different point. For examples, a team member says, "As we consider the Affirmation's first argument on the benefits of solar power, we would like you to cross apply our first negative argument on the huge cost of alternate energy sources (solar being one of them) to this AFF contention. Solar energy may be nice but it is going to cost WAY TOO MUCH."

- If the Affirmation presented a plan, you will need to attack it. (More on this in a later chapter.)

Example: *The Affirmation's plan will not solve the harms and will actually be harmful to the public. First,*

- Next move to the Affirmation's case and **ATTACK** each point in the order that they were presented. Caution – sometimes the first negative spends so much time presenting their Negative arguments that they don't leave time to attack the Affirmation's case. You must watch the clock so that you save time for the Affirmation attack – this is crucial.



Example: *The Affirmation's first contention is that we are too dependent on foreign oil. We would argue first that the negation shows you no HARM in this. They present no examples of where our dependence has led to a significant harm to U.S. citizens. Second, we argue that the U.S. is already taking steps to minimize our need to get oil from other countries. We are looking for sources within our own country. Statistics show that the U.S. has enough of its own supplies to last for hundreds of years...*

- After you have completed your case, you quickly conclude by summarizing your key points and urge a vote for the Negation.

Example: *Because the Affirmation has a faulty definition of terms and has presented arguments that are flawed AND because we have provided two solid arguments supporting the need to value economic considerations, we ask for a Negation ballot.*

So here's the First Negation Checklist

- ☐ I have given my name and a roadmap
- ☐ I have given a SHORT introduction and stated that we are opposed to the resolution.

- ☐ I have explained our problems with the way the Affirmative framed the debate
 - ☐ If I think they labeled the type of motion incorrectly, I explained why
 - ☐ If I didn't like the judging criteria, I have explained why and suggested another one
 - ☐ If I didn't like the Definition of Terms, I explained why and offered others
- ☐ I have presented at least 2 negative contentions
- ☐ If it is a policy debate, I have argued my problems with the Affirmative plan
- ☐ I have attacked each of the Affirmation's claims or contentions
- ☐ I have given a conclusion

Second Affirmation (or Government) Constructive Speech

- Give your name and a roadmap of your speech. Tell the judge what order you will be discussing things.

Example: *Hello, my name is Milo M for the Affirmation. During these 7 minutes, I will first discuss the negation's concerns with the definitions, then I will address the Negation's case, and finally I will go back to the affirmation's contentions and show why the responses of the Negation aren't significant. Let's begin....*

- Start with a strong opening line and reaffirm that you believe in the proposition.



Example: *How we handle energy in the next few years will be vitally important. My partner and I continue to believe that alternate energy sources are our best future, and we support the resolution: Resolved: the USFG should significantly increase the use of alternate energy sources.*

- If they attacked any elements of your framing of the debate – the type of resolution it was, the judging criteria, or the definition of terms, you must explain why the Negative is wrong and you are right.

- Go to the negation's case arguments – state each one and then refute it – in other words, break it down.

Example: *The negation told you that developing alternate energy sources will cost too much. We disagree. We believe that we will actually stimulate the economy by creating jobs. Researching and developing alternate energy sources will provide hundreds of thousands of new jobs in our economy. Giving handouts in terms of longer unemployment benefits or more food stamps is only a short-term solution. Creating new jobs for those on unemployment will create lasting and sustainable economic growth.*

- If you are doing a policy debate, and the Negative attacked your plan, you must answer their attacks. Don't forget to use **FIAT** if it applies. (Fiat is explained in Chapter 13.)



- Next, go back to your affirmation contentions and REBUILD them. Don't simply repeat them, but analyze what the negation said and show that it is not correct. You want to EXTEND on their analysis.

Example: *Our first argument was that dependence on oil was bad. The Negation wants us to first show you the harm in this. I would point to the recent hike in gas prices. The U.S. is at the mercy of oil rich countries, and they can charge whatever they want for their oil. The higher cost must be born by U.S. drivers, and that's a real hardship for many. That is the harm. Next, they tell you we could use oil supplies we have here in the U.S. – we would argue that getting that oil would require drilling in highly environmentally sensitive areas. Look at the recent oil spill in the gulf region of*

the U.S. It is better all around to lessen our dependence on oil and look at friendlier alternative energy sources that will free us from oil-wealthy countries.

- Finally, summarize the Affirmative position for the judge.

Example: *Let's look back. The Affirmative has given you three significant arguments showing that using alternate energy sources must be our top priority. We have analyzed the negative's contentions, proving that developing jobs from alternative energy sources is the BEST way to help the economy, and that, contrary to their assertion, alternate forms of energy are well-developed enough to be a viable energy source. The conclusion is simple: a vote for the Affirmation.*

So here's the Second Affirmation Checklist

- ☐ I have given a short Introduction
- ☐ I have re-affirmed our position in favor of the resolution.
- ☐ I have provided a road map
- ☐ If the Negative didn't like how we framed the debate, I have answered their concerns:
 - ☐ If they didn't like how we labeled the type of motion I have explained why we are correct.
 - ☐ If they suggested another judging criteria, I have explained why ours is better.
 - ☐ If they didn't like our Definition of Terms, I have explained why ours are fair
- ☐ I have attacked each of the negative contentions
- ☐ If it is a policy debate, I have answered any attacks on our Affirmative plan
 - ☐ I have used fiat (if it applies) and explained to the judge what fiat is
- ☐ I have rebuilt each of our claims or contentions
 - ☐ I have pointed out the flaws in the Negative attacks
 - ☐ I have extended arguments – not just repeated what my partner said
- ☐ I have given a conclusion

Second Negation (or Negative) Constructive Speech

- Give your name and an off-time roadmap of your speech – tell the judge what order you will be discussing things.

Example: *Hi, I am Michele A. for the Negation. Here's where I'll be going during the next 7 minutes. I will first handle our continued problem with the definition of terms, then move to the attacks on our negative contentions, and finally I will go back up to the top of the flow to deal with the Affirmation's case. Turning now to the unreasonable definition of terms....*



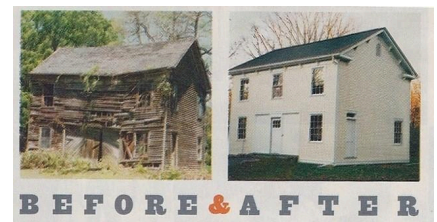
- Start with an opening line and reaffirm the negative position.



Example: *If you asked a guy in the unemployment line, a woman standing in front of her foreclosed home, or a young adult with huge college loans --Which do you want -- Alternate energy sources or economic prosperity? -- I think we know what they would answer. Economic security. This and the other arguments we've presented show why the Negation is against this resolution.*

- If you're still not happy with any parts of the framing of the debate, EXTEND on the arguments presented by the AFF. Don't simply repeat what your partner already said.
- Go to the Negative Case first. Discuss the contentions your partner brought up. Deal with each response made by the Affirmation to those contentions. REBUILD your contentions so they are airtight again – they may have been shredded by the Affirmation's attack but now is the time to fix and rebuild them. Point out to the judge if the argument was dropped. Again, don't just repeat what has been said by your partner, answer the attacks of the Affirmation. **EXTEND!**

Example: *Our first contention was that it will take an influx of money from the government to stimulate the economy enough. The Affirmation said it is better to stimulate the economy through jobs that will come from expanding the alternate energy sector. We don't believe that this will create enough jobs. First most of the initial jobs will be for specially trained scientists and engineers – those groups aren't the ones groups aren't the ones hurting for jobs right now – they aren't the ones who need them. Second, the jobs created will only last if the company lasts. Look at Solyndra – Obama poured billions into that company and it went bankrupt. When it did, so did the jobs that it created. And finally, we need a STOP GAP measure because jobs are needed now – not in 10 years.*



- If this is a policy debate, now is the time to again discuss and extend on the problems with the Affirmative's plan. Show why your concerns are still valid, answer AFF attacks.

- Next go back to the affirmation contentions that were rebuilt during the 2nd Affirmation speech. Guess what – you need to tear down what they just rebuilt.

Example: *The Affirmation told you that dependence on oil was bad, and we responded that we needed to see the harm in this. The Affirmation responds that there have been recent hikes in oil prices and that the U.S. is at the mercy of oil rich countries. In response, we would argue that energy prices will certainly be higher under their case. Companies that research and develop alternate energy sources must recoup their expenses, and they will hit up the American taxpayer to get them. Those costs are likely to be higher than the current price of oil. As to being at the mercy of oil rich countries, we would argue that those countries need us as much as we need them. Their economies are almost exclusively based on their oil sales, so they need us, and they need to set fair market values.*

- Finally, in the conclusion, summarize the Negation position for the judge.

Example: *Remember this debate is on what do we value most – alternate energy sources or economic prosperity for our citizens. While solar and wind energy seem nice, we have clearly shown that we need to place a priority on our ailing economy and protect our citizens. The Affirmation doesn't present a significant harm, while we have presented benefits to our citizens NOW – the choice is clear, and it is a vote for the Negation.*



So here's the Second Negation Checklist

- ☐ I have given my name and an off-time roadmap
- ☐ I have provided a short introduction and stated the resolution.
- ☐ If we didn't like how the Affirmation framed the debate, I have explained our problems one last time.
 - ☐ If we didn't like how they labeled the type of motion, I have extended on our argument.
 - ☐ If we didn't like their judging criteria, I have extended on why ours is better.
 - ☐ If we didn't like their Def of Terms, I have extended on why ours are more fair
- ☐ I have rebuilt the negative case by extending and answering the attacks by the Affirmation
- ☐ If it is a policy debate, I have explained why we still have concerns with their plan
- ☐ I have again explained the weaknesses in each of the AFF arguments through extending on the 2nd AFF Analysis
 - ☐ I have pointed out the flaws in the AFF analysis
 - ☐ I have extended arguments – not just repeated what my partner said
- ☐ I have given a conclusion

IMPORTANT HINT – See Addendum 5 for those sheets that summarize each speech in the debate.

Chapter 11

POC, POI (not the Hawaiian Kind), and POO (not the Dog Kind) Points of Clarification, Points of Information, and Points of Order

Points of Clarification



A **point of clarification (POC)** is a question asked of the speaker that is **non-argumentative and seeks to get an explanation of something the questioner did not hear or understand**. A POC can be an important tool for teams – if you miss an argument, how can you attack it? If you don't understand what the team meant by a contention, your attack on it may be off-base and not on point at all. Knowing and understanding the other team's contentions and arguments is vitally important for a debate, and asking a POC can help you understand this. So when you don't catch something the speaker said, **ASK A POC!**

Example: *Can you explain once again how you plan to pay for this multi-billion dollar plan without raising ANY taxes?*

But keep these rules in mind: Points of Clarification can be asked only during the first two speeches where the case of the AFF and NEG are being presented. The speaker must accept all POCs. Time stops for POCs. Some tournaments allow POCs and some do not – you will need to check the rules at each tournament.

Points of Information



A Point of information (also known as P-O-I) is a statement or question asked by the opposing team about the case being presented by the debater speaking. Points of information can be made during ALL constructive speeches (**not rebuttals**); however, the first and last minute of each speech is known as **protected time**, and no points of information can be asked or made. If a speech ends early, the protected time ends, and the opposing team can make/ask a point of information. Points of information can be questions or statements. Both those making the point and taking the point **MUST BE POLITE AND RESPECTFUL!** The speaker does not have to take a POI.

If you are MAKING a point of information, remember these pointers:

1. You **SHOULD** always try to make at least one point of information – They impress the judges, and often, they are on the judges' sheet as criteria to use in making the decision as to which team wins. They show the judge that you are capable of challenging your opponent's arguments.

2. Make your point of information count. Good ones direct the judge's attention to what you believe are the relevant issues or crucial weaknesses in the opposition's case. You will probably only get one point of information during your opponent's speech, so make your POI when you KNOW it will count.
3. To get recognized, you should stand as a signal to the speaker. You can also politely say, "Point of information," "Will the speaker take a Point of Information," or "On that Point"
4. The member of your team who is NOT speaking next should be the one to make the point of information. That gives your teammate more time to prep. But be sure your teammate knows the answer, so that they can use it in their speech.
5. Make your points of information last no longer than 15 seconds. Otherwise, both your opponent and the judge will get confused. If you can't make your point in 15 seconds or less, you aren't being an effective communicator, and it reflects poorly on you.
6. If you have a follow-up question, then you need to ask the speaker if it is OK to ask another question. It is RUDE to try to take over a speech by firing POIs at a speaker.
7. If you can include facts or statistics in your points – especially if the other team has been speaking in generalities – do it. It helps to contrast the fact that you are talking factually while they have no factual basis for what they are saying.
8. Be sure to **use the information** you get in your future speech. If you have uncovered a weakness through your point of information, you want to hammer on that in your speech. Show the impact of that weakness on their case.

Here are five benefits for your team if you are effective with your POIs:

1. **You can point out that the opposing side may be interpreting the proposition incorrectly –**
Example: *Can you tell me how your case on steam power adequately addresses all forms of alternative energy as the resolution intends?"*
2. **You can undermine the opposing sides' factual material** – you will often hear speakers use half-truths, exaggeration, or misinformation, and it is good to call them on it.
Example: *You said that most children don't watch as much TV anymore. However, the evidence we presented shows that the average child watches 5 hours of television a day; in other words, over 20% of their day is in front of the TV screen. I'd say that's pretty significant.*
3. **You can advance an argument you plan to use later** – If you have already thought about the arguments that the other side might bring up and you have figured out a response to them, you might be able to phrase a POI to advance your response argument. For instance, let's say you are debating expanding the school breakfast program. You have figured out that the other side will probably say that breakfasts are providing important nutrition for kids, but you have some information showing that those breakfasts contain dairy products which aren't always healthy. So you advance your argument through your POI.
Example: *Does the federal breakfast program include dairy?*

You already know that the other side will answer, "Yes, of course, it includes dairy."

Now you are set up to argue in your next speech that dairy products can increase asthma, can reduce immunity to bacterial infections, and can cause many problems for children, who are often lactose intolerant.

4. **You can significantly weaken an argument of the opposing side** -- If you can show a weakness in their logic or the fact that they have no causal link, you can destroy their argument.

Example – *Your plan calls for us to invest millions of US tax dollars into companies currently researching alternative energy sources. Can you guarantee that all these companies will be successful in creating a practical, economic alternate energy source or will they turn out like Solyndra?*

If you are TAKING a point of information, remember these pointers:

1. You **SHOULD** generally take at least one point of information – If you don't, it looks like you are scared to answer questions or that you are afraid your case is weak. It also allows you to hear what your opponents are thinking and what arguments that they might be planning. You can nip those arguments in the bud or get a chance to prepare a response for arguments you now know they will make later. However, if you are at a key point in your speech, it is probably best to say, "Not at this time."
2. Don't let the speaker ask more than one point of information at a time – You control the points of information. Never let them take over and ask several questions at once. The time it takes to be asked and to answer the question comes out of YOUR time. Each time they want to make a point of information, they need to get permission from you. After taking your first POI, it is perfectly acceptable to say, "I will only take additional points of information if there is time remaining at the end of my speech."
3. Keep your answers as brief as you can – Remember, if you talk too long, you will use up all your speech time answering the other side.
4. Sound confident – Listen to the point of information carefully and try to answer confidently. Even if you aren't confident, keep a strong poker face – don't let your opponents or your judge see that you are feeling unsure.

Points of Order

A point of order (AKA P-O-O) is when a member of your team points out that a member of the other team has introduced a new argument in rebuttal. Remember, no new arguments can be presented during rebuttals, but new evidence and new analysis of a previous argument can be made. If this was not allowed, then the AFF would not be able to answer any arguments/attacks presented in the last NEG constructive speech. The Point of Order can only be made during REBUTTAL speeches. When the Point of Order is made, the clock is immediately stopped. The team which noticed the infraction rises to a Point of Order, and in 15 seconds or less, explains to the judge what they believe the new argument was. The other team has a chance to respond, and their response can only take 15 seconds. The time spent discussing the Point of Order does NOT come out of the speaker's time. The clock will restart when both teams have stated their position. The judge will listen but does not need to tell you whether he/she agrees or disagrees with the Point of Order. If the judge felt the team did make a new argument, they are instructed not to consider that argument in their decision.



Chapter 12

The Best Laid Plans

Creating an Affirmation Plan for a Policy Proposition

Debating a POLICY resolution is a little more difficult than debating either a resolution of fact or value. If you are debating a POLICY proposition, you are saying that there is something WRONG with the status quo (the way things are right now) and it must be changed. The current system is broken and needs fixing. If that is true, then you MUST present a plan or policy to solve whatever you have said is wrong. In other words, you have to solve the harms in the status quo, and you NEED a plan to do it. **If an Affirmative team doesn't include a plan in a policy debate, they should lose right away.** So if you are AFF, don't forget to put in a plan. Here is how to set up an Affirmation case and plan with a policy resolution:



Step 1 – Look at the resolution – Create a **simple** proposal or plan to achieve that resolution.

Let's say the resolution is: California should require all students in public schools to wear uniforms.

Your plan might be:

1. The CA Department of Education will oversee this plan, with an implementation date of 2028.
2. Schools will have discretion to choose their own uniforms.
3. The state will provide financial assistance for low-income families in their budget.
4. Schools choosing not to follow this plan will see their educational funds cut.

When you are thinking about the plan, remember to keep it simple. Decide the following:

1. The Actor or Agency – who will implement and enforce your plan. Choose a responsible group.
2. The Timeline -- when will they do it. Be sure to set a reasonable time where the mandate can be accomplished.
3. The Mandate -- what will they do, what specific action/actions will they take
4. The Funding – how will you pay for your plan – through taxes, from the general budget etc.



Step 2 – Now, instead of discussing the problems or arguments with the status quo, you are going to give us the advantages or benefits that come from adopting your plan. In other words, you replace contentions with advantages/benefits. Aim for at least three advantages or benefits.

Example: We lessen bullying and create a safer environment for students.

Now structure your advantage...just like you did your contentions.

- ★ **Show the current harm:** Kids are bullied and feel unsafe at school.
- ★ **Give the warrant and evidence:** Students currently feel an unhealthy need to conform to what other students think they should be wearing. Scitechnol Journal, 11/7/22 – “As adolescents get older, they become increasingly fashion conscious and bully their peers more for the clothing they wear.”
- ★ **Explain that your plan solves the problem:** If all students wear the same uniform on campus, there is nothing to bully students about. Reduces their need to conform
- ★ **Tell the judge the impact of this:** Students feel less pressure, bullying is reduced, and the campus feels safer.

So the First AFF in a policy debate will look like this:

1. Short introduction
2. State the resolution
3. Frame the resolution – tell the judge that this is a policy debate, give the judge a voting criteria, and define the terms
4. **Present the plan**
5. Give the first advantage or benefit of the plan.
 - State each advantage, show the problem in the status quo,
 - Give warrant and evidence,
 - Show how your plan solves the problem, making it more advantageous than the status quo.
 - Finally show the impact.
6. Give the second advantage – same as for the first advantage
7. Give the third advantage
8. Conclude the speech.

Some additional pointers:

- Your plan can be done by:
 - Model legislation – look for models or other similar policies that have been tried elsewhere.
 - Agency or executive action – place it under the jurisdiction of a particular agency or department or have the president do it through executive order.
 - New law or constitutional amendment – have congress legislate or pass a law to enact your ideas
 - Court decree – have the court make a determination
- Always take a moment during your prep time to play devil’s advocate – think about what the Negation will say about your plan and how you can answer those attacks. Think about the harms you presented – does your plan really solve the harms? Think about disadvantages that might come from adopting your plan – can you devise a way to get rid of them? By looking at your plan through the eyes of your opponents, you may be able to get rid of any problems BEFORE the debate even starts.

Chapter 13

Fiat – No, We’re Not Talking Cars Here!

Let’s be honest: No Affirmative team can figure out a perfect plan in 20 minutes. The Negative could always find something wrong with it – Congress won’t pass it, we will never get all the states to agree to a Constitutional amendment, we don’t have the money, the President will veto it. And the list goes on and on. If the Negative can ALWAYS find something wrong with it, it would mean the Negative would always win a policy debate. So to even the playing field, we have something called

“FIAT”

Yes, Fiat is the name of a car, but that’s not what the word means in debate. In parliamentary debate, “fiat” refers to a debater’s right to ASSUME that the AFFIRMATIVE plan WILL be enacted. In other words, when the AFF runs a plan, they don’t have to argue that the plan will be adopted or that enforcement of the plan will occur – only that it **should** occur. For the purpose of this one debate, fiat allows the Affirmative to pretend that the plan they are advocating WILL be put in operation. Then, the AFF only needs to argue that it would be advantageous if their plan were implemented. By putting in a phrase at the end of your plan that says,



- This plan will be implemented through normal means, OR · This will be done through any regular procedures required OR
- Our plan will be adopted by any and all Constitutional means.

you are saying that FIAT will make all this happen

The AFF, through FIAT, gets to assume that their plan will happen. In other words, the AFF can be assured that:

- The body (Congress, the USFG, the judicial systems etc) will implement it
- The law (mandate, guidelines etc.) they have proposed will go into effect, and
- Their proposal will be funded and enforced (not circumvented)

For example, if the AFF wants to “implement state-wide mandatory water rationing through a series of executive mandates from the Governor” as their plan to solve the water shortage, FIAT means that they can assume

1. The governor can and will do it;
2. The mandates will occur; and
3. The mandates will be funded and enforced.

So now the focus of the debate becomes not “if water rationing will happen” but “whether water rationing is a good plan to solve the water shortage.” It also means that Negative arguments like “The

legislature is against it,” “That law will never pass – the people don’t want it,” or “that group won’t enforce it,” are no longer issues.

Of course, FIAT doesn’t mean that the Affirmative gets to FIAT through all the advantages too. That would mean the AFF would always win. Again to even the playing field, the Negative can still argue that:

1. The plan will not solve the problems in the status quo -- SOLVENCY
2. The plan will not be able to get the advantages the AFF claims
3. The plan will create more disadvantages

You will learn more about how the Negative can attack the Affirmation plan in the next chapter.



And what if your judge doesn’t know what FIAT is? It will most likely happen, and you need to be able to explain it, so that the judge understands what an important idea it is. Remember, just throwing out the word FIAT will NOT BE ENOUGH.

Below you will find some direct source material that explains and supports FIAT. You should learn these sources and also have this information available should the judge want to see it.

Fiat -- A term used to describe the process that allows debate of a proposed plan as if it were already adopted. Shuster, Kate & John Meany. Introducing Policy Debate.

www.cahssa.org/yahoo_site_admin/assets/docs/Parliamentary_Debate_Intro.9104950.pdf

“Fiat” refers to a debater’s right to assume that her plan will happen. In other words, when a debater runs a plan or a counterplan, she does not have to argue that the plan is likely to happen. She needs only to argue that it would be net advantageous if the plan were implemented. (Victory Briefs. <http://victorybriefs.com/vbd/2012/12>)

The Limitations of Fiat: You cannot fiat Solvency. (Houston Urban Debate League – Debate II houstonurbandebateleague.org/wp.../u.../DebateII Lectures-Fiat.doc)

Normal Means: “Normal means” allows the affirmative to focus on the outcome of the legislation not the passage of legislation. (Houston Urban Debate League – Debate II houstonurbandebateleague.org/wp.../u.../DebateII Lectures-Fiat.doc)

Funding – The affirmative plan is guaranteed that the plan will be funded and that funding will be protected with the passage of plan. This funding must come from the normal avenues. (Houston Urban Debate League – Debate II houstonurbandebateleague.org/wp.../u.../DebateII Lectures-Fiat.doc)

Chapter 14

Choose Your Weapons -- Attacking the Affirmation Plan

When the resolution / proposition is one of **POLICY**, the Affirmation should present a plan to solve the harms / contentions that they present. And the Negation has the responsibility to attack this plan. The Negation can easily win the debate with a good plan attack. Far too many teams forget to put in plan attacks, and honestly, it is one of the easiest ways to win a policy debate. So here are some strategies you can use in attacking an Affirmative plan. Don't use all of them – choose only those that apply to their plan.

If the Affirmation has NO plan, you can argue two things –

- If they don't have a plan, they can't solve the harms / contentions that they brought up. And there is no reason to vote for the Affirmation if they don't solve the problems.
- If we don't know what their plan is, how can we know that it will be better than the status quo (the system that we already have). It could create worse problems, cost money etc. So we can't vote for a plan that is unknown.



Tell your judge: "No plan" means that the Negation wins.

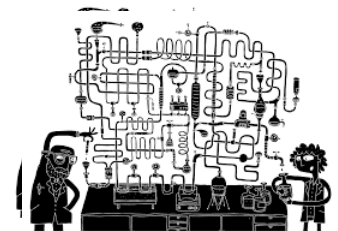
If the Affirmation has a plan....

As you have already learned, you can't really argue about whether the plan will happen, whether we can fund it, and that it will be put into operation. All that is covered under the concept of "fiat" which you learned about in the last chapter. Fiat says that, for the purpose of this debate, we have to assume that the plan will happen. So what's a Negative team to do? How can they attack a plan?



Don't worry – the Negative has a number of ways to attack that plan.

Workability – Sure, we have said that, for purposes of the date today, the plan will go into effect, but is it really going to work? Can the actor (the administrator/enforcer) handle the plan? Do they know enough to make it work? Is it financially possible to do? Have they provided enough money to make it happen? Where will it come from? And here is the beginning of a disadvantage: Will we have to hurt other programs in order to fund it? Is the timeline reasonable – can the AFF really have all this happen in the period of time they have allotted. SO YES, fiat says the plan will be put in place, but the NEG argues that it is not going to be workable and will eventually fail.



Tell your judge: This plan will pass for purposes of this debate, but it is doomed to failure because of plan flaws. Why do we want to put into a plan that will later fail?

Solvency – Their plan sounds good, but it doesn't really solve the harms that they presented earlier. Or if they presented advantages, can the AFF guarantee that it can achieve those advantages? In other words the plan they designed really won't take care of the problem and it won't produce the impacts they claim. Those problems will still be around AFTER the plan is implemented. And what do we tell the judge? Judge, why do we want to change the status quo, spend a bunch of money, and still not solve the problems?

Tell your judge: This is a voting issue. If the plan won't solve the problems (or give the advantages claimed,) then the Affirmation case falls.

Inherency – The status quo (the system that we currently have) can already do what the Affirmation plan is suggesting. There are no barriers preventing the status quo from doing it. Therefore, there is no need to set up a whole new plan. Use the system that we already have.

Tell your judge: This is a voting issue. If the status quo is already taking care of the problem, there is no need to vote for this resolution.

New Disadvantages – New problems will result if the plan is put into place – Examine the plan to see if new problems might occur if it is implemented. This is a good place to argue that the Affirmation creates more harms than benefits, that the disadvantages to their plan far outweigh any advantages they might claim. And why would we want to create new problems that currently don't exist?

Tell your judge: This plan creates new disadvantages that didn't exist before – those disadvantages outweigh any advantages they claim, and that is a voting issue.

Funding Disadvantage – While FIAT tells us that we need to assume that funding will be available for the plan, we can argue that the funding will mean that other programs will need to be cut. And that is a massive disadvantage. If you look at information about the US budget, you can see that 2/3s of the US budget is already allocated and CAN'T BE TOUCHED. So we can only get money to fund a federal plan through raising taxes or cutting from the 1/3 of the budget that is discretionary. Guess what programs are in that discretionary section – transportation, energy and environment, housing, veteran's benefits, and education. So Negative, you can argue how bad it would be to raise taxes or to cut some of the programs funded by the discretionary budget.



Tell your judge: This is a voting issue. If the Aff plan takes away money from other programs we fund, we have to vote it down.

Let's see how it might work in a real debate with a policy proposition. Here's the proposition:



Resolution: The college system will no longer use SAT/ACT type tests as criteria for admission.

The Affirmation presents a plan:

As of January 1, 2028, all college admissions offices will stop requiring SAT/ACT tests for admission, relying on other measures instead. Schools failing to do this will be denied federal monies. This measure will be enforced by the Department of Education, and any funding required will be through normal means.

The Affirmation then presents their advantages:

1. Our plan will not favor the wealthy, as the current SAT/ACT tests do.
2. Our plan will no longer benefit the good test taker as the current tests do.
3. Our tests will stop the cheating that is now happening with the SAT/ACT tests.

Here's what you, as the Negation, might argue as your plan attacks:

The Affirmation's plan is not workable. WORKABILITY

- *Some colleges don't receive federal monies so the enforcement of these rules on some colleges would be impossible.*
- *Trump wants to get rid of the Department of Education, and the AFF has no alternative department to handle this, should that happen.*

For these reasons, the AFFs plan will fail at some point, and they won't be able to guarantee any advantages.

The Affirmation's plan does not solve for the harms that they presented. SOLVENCY

- *First, admissions will still favor the wealthy under their plan. Only the wealthy will be able to pay for help with other admissions criteria like AP tests, tutors, and help on college essays. And only the wealthy will be able to travel to colleges for interviews.*
- *The Affirmation's plan still favors good test-takers. Those who do well on school tests will get higher GPAs, and good test takers will score higher on AP tests, giving them an advantage over those who don't.*
- *Cheating will still occur in their system. You can still cheat on the application or have someone, like ChatGPT, write your essay for you.*

For these 3 reasons, the Affirmation's plan does not solve the harms presented. And if it doesn't solve the harms, there is no reason for an Affirmation ballot in this debate.

The Affirmation's plan is not inherent. INHERENCY

They are not instituting any mechanisms that aren't already available under the status quo. Our college admissions already use GPA, AP classes, applications, written essays, and interviews. If anything, the current system is more flexible than the one that they suggest. The present system allows for colleges to select the criteria that they want to use in order to get the students most likely

to succeed -- instead of forcing them to a set criteria. The present system can do everything the Affirmation suggests and more – obviously the system we have now is the superior alternative.

The Affirmation's plans will create new harms that didn't exist before. DISADVANTAGES

- *First, college admissions will have a much tougher job selecting potentially successful students. They won't have universal standards like those provided in an SAT test to judge students' competency – for instance, when using GPA, an A in one school may not be equal to an A in another school, so how do you differentiate between candidates?*
- *Second, this process is much more cumbersome. It will take longer to sort through and determine viable candidates. It will end up costing the colleges a great deal more money. And it may delay by months when seniors get their acceptance letters.*

Beware: Instead of just attacking the Affirmative, the Negative can also introduce something called a **counter plan**, which they maintain will be better than the Affirmative's plan! You will learn more about this in Chapter 22.

Chapter 15

Debate Is, Pardon My Expression, The S.H.I.T.S. – A Review of Some of the Best Generic Attacks

“Stock” or “generic” attack arguments are arguments that can be applied to almost every contention presented. Stock arguments are good to remember – especially when you don’t have any concrete facts or information. Stock arguments can also be some of the most effective arguments you can use. To easily remember the stock arguments, debaters often use the acronym “S.H.I.T.S.”

Significance -- The affirmation argues that there are significant problems in our present system.



The negation replies: How *significant* is the problem that you are trying to remedy? How many people does it impact? How much money does it really cost in light of our entire budget? Is the problem REALLY big, or in the overall scheme of things, is it not that important? Let’s say the topic is “No more off-shore drilling for oil” and the affirmation says that “oil spills cause

significant problems.” You might argue significance – How many oil spills are there relative to all the oil rigs that are out there? Are oil spills really common? How long-lasting are the effects on the local areas?

Harms – The affirmation argues that there are many harms that occur in our present system.

The negation replies: You need to quantify the problems for us – don’t just tell us that they exist. We want quantifiable proof. Does the harm have a huge or small impact? Does the harm really impact our rights, freedom, happiness? (As you can see the HARM and the SIGNIFICANCE are very similar arguments.) Let’s talk about oil drilling again. Let’s say that the affirmation says that it hurts wildlife. You could ask for the measurable effects of the harm – Exactly how many animals died? – or you could say that lots of things hurt wildlife – riding in a boat, building a road etc, but the rewards overshadow the harm. And what about the harms of shutting down oil drilling – loss of jobs, loss of income to the nation, problems in running businesses without oil, problems with transportation, cost of gas to American people. Aren’t these harms greater in the long run?



Inherency – The affirmation argues that this problem is inherent (built in) to the present system and the problem can’t be solved until the system is changed. They say there is a barrier in the status quo preventing the adoption of the plan, and the barrier must be removed to get the plan to work or the problems to be solved.



The negation replies: What is *inherent* in the status quo that prevents your problem from already being solved? Why do we need to adopt this plan – can’t we easily take care of it under our current system or the status quo? Why do we need to create a new department – we already have one that works on this problem? We already have laws on the books – we just need to enforce them more. Again, back to oil drilling. You say, “We already have laws and safety measures on the books. They simply need to be enforced. There is

nothing inherent in the status quo that would prevent us from stopping oil rig leaks.”

Topicality – The affirmation says our case clearly deals with the topic wording. It is on topic.

The negation replies: Does your case fall within the *topic*? Does your case meet the parameters of the resolution? You have chosen an obscure way to look at the topic – it is not what the writers of the resolution intended. The Negation argues that the Affirmation’s case strays

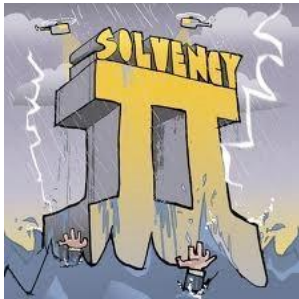
too far from the obvious meaning of the topic, that it is off the topic or out of bounds for the debate. For example, if the

resolution is to have the USFG prohibit off-shore drilling and the AFF decides to prohibit the off-shore drilling only “off California coasts,” you could argue that this is not topical – it does not fulfill the intent of the resolution, and thus, is not topical. Or if the

Affirmation decided to continue to allow the current off-shore drilling to continue, but not allow any more rigs to be built, the Negative could again argue that the writers of the resolution intended this to encompass ALL off-shore drilling, not just future drilling rigs.



Solvency – The affirmation says that adopting the resolution and our plan will solve the problems that we have presented.



The negation replies: Does your plan actually *solve* the problem? You said the present system costs too much – but your plan will cost money. You said that there is corruption in the present system, but your plan could still have corruption. Your plan will still cause the problems that you say exist under our present system. Back to our off-shore drilling example, they contend that off-shore drilling hurts the environment and they suggest that we will use solar and wind energy. You might argue that these will still hurt the environment – they are a blight on the land; when their use is over, they go into landfills; they do not create as much energy, so there must be more of them. In other words, they really don’t solve the problem of protecting our environment.

Chapter 16

You're Going Down!

Winning in Rebuttals

Most good debates are won or lost in the rebuttals. The rebuttals are the final speeches for each side of the debate – they are the LAST opportunity each side will have to explain why they should win. Students skilled in rebuttals in parliamentary debate do not attempt to cover every tiny issue that has been discussed in the debate, but instead, they cull down the arguments and select what they believe are their side's WINNING and VOTING issues. They don't simply repeat what's already been said – instead, they sort through the debate and choose to emphasize those arguments that they believe will give them the WIN!



Hint: If you're simply repeating the arguments that were already presented, you're probably boring the judge and you are not helping the judge to see why your team should win!

FIRST and foremost, remember, new arguments may NOT be introduced in the rebuttal. The arguments must have been introduced in the constructives. However, if it is the first time the AFF has had a chance to respond to a new point made by the second NC, they can bring up a new response. Otherwise, in rebuttals, the speakers can only EXTEND ON EARLIER ARGUMENTS. You CAN'T INTRODUCE NEW ARGUMENTS. In other words, a rebuttal speaker can present new analysis of already established and important arguments, but they can't present a new, never introduced contention. If a team makes a completely NEW argument in their rebuttal speech, the other side can rise to a Point of Order (Look back at Chapter 11)) You explain to the judge, "This is a new argument, and the judging rules say this can't be done. We don't think it should be considered in your decision."

SECOND, don't forget the judging criteria that was set up early in the debate. You told the judge that he/she should judge the debate on this criteria! Now, in the rebuttal, you should clearly relate how the points you believe you've won meet the judging criteria. Consider beginning your speech with something like:

At the beginning of this debate, we asked that you, our judge, base your decision on a criteria of net benefits – in other words, the team with the most benefits should get your ballot. In this rebuttal, I am going to show you all the benefits you receive under the AFFs (or NEG's) position and how we have significantly more than the other side, and thus, deserve the win.

THIRD, leave the flow sheet behind. Don't simply go down your flow sheet and argue the same points in the same way you already have argued in the constructives. Don't repeat your last speech. Instead, try one of these strategies:

- Set up your VOTING or WINNING arguments. Circle the points you think you have won and emphasize those points. Consider using the IMPACT part of each argument as your key points. For instance, don't argue your contention: Trash in our ocean is a problem. Instead, say,

“Judge, we prevent tons of waste from entering our ocean each year and contaminating our water.”

- Points of Clash – Pick out the main areas where you and the other side clashed. Which of the arguments in the debate have been most significant and contentious? Which are the arguments you think the judge found most important? Those are the ones that you call the Points of Clash. Tell your judge each point of clash – Explain why you win it. Don’t forget to look at who has the greatest impact from that point of clash as a reason of why you won it.

FOURTH, save a little time to condense the debate into a quick look at what the AFF and NEG have done. In other words, you weigh out the two sides and show who comes out ahead. (More detailed information on Weighing Mechanisms are found in Chapter 21.) Here are a couple of rebuttal strategies that teams can use:



Let’s weigh the key arguments in this case. On their side, you have....(*make their arguments seem little and unimportant*) and on our side, you have...(make this list longer and make them seem more important.)



Let’s think about what the U.S. (world) would be like under their plan: (*bring up all the problems, disadvantages etc.*) **and here’s what the U.S. would look like if you support the status quo:** (*bring up all the advantages, etc. of sticking with the status quo.*)

You can reverse the one above so it is more for the Affirmation: Let’s look at what we’ve got with the status quo (*state all the bad things you’ve been discussing in the debate*) and let’s look at how much better it would be if you adopt our plan (*paint a rosy picture of all that your plan will accomplish.*



We need a reality check. The Affirmation (or Negation) wants you to look through rose-colored glasses. They have painted a rosy picture of the status quo (or their plan or their position). Here’s what we’re really talking about....(*bring up all the problems and disadvantages with their case.*)



The other side has told you their key issues in today’s debate, but those issues aren’t VOTING issues. These are the VOTING issues in this debate (*bring up all the arguments that you think you won.*



And here's my personal favorite: **The “EVEN IF” Rebuttal!**

In this kind of rebuttal, you first give your attacks/responses to what you believe are the other side's key issues. You do the best job you can to destroy the main points of their case, and then you say to the judge,

BUT EVEN IF WE LOSE THESE POINTS, WE STILL WIN BECAUSE.... And then you tell the judge what your winning arguments are.

Here are some examples of this strategy in action:

- Even if you buy the Negative's argument that our plan increases government spending, we still win the debate because we have proved that that spending is essential and brings much needed advantages.
- Even if you believe the Affirmative that alternate sources of energy are good, we still win because we've shown you that the economic concerns of the people have to be a higher priority at the present time. And their plan will cost too much, bringing severe hardship to our citizens. Let me explain.....
- Even if the Affirmation (Negation) TELLS you they didn't like our argument on the United States' diminishing power in the world markets, we win because the fact remains that they haven't presented you with any evidence and we have!

Debates are often won (or lost) in the rebuttals! This last speech is vitally important and can “make or break the debate.”



Make it GREAT, make it DIFFERENT, make it CLEAR, make it ORGANIZED
so the judge KNOWS you deserve the ballot.

Chapter 17

Taking It to the Next Level – A Few More Tips on Refining your Debating Skills

You will find some pointers below for both Affirmation and Negation speakers, pointers that will take your debating to the next level.

General tips for both sides

1. Consider opening the debate with an overarching observation that you want the judge to keep in his/her mind as he listens to the debate. **Then come back to that observation in the rebuttal.** For instances, at the start of the debate, you say the following:



Example: *Initial Observation – “As we begin today’s debate, I want to make one important observation. The government only has 1/3 of the budget each year that is not already allocated for mandatory expenditures for such things as social security, education, and infrastructure. How we spend that 1/3 of the discretionary funds will be increasingly more important. And when we spend more money in one area, that will mean we must cut some other valuable program. Keep this in mind as we decide whether we should increase funding to our space program.”*

In rebuttal – (right at the end of your speech), come back to that overarching observation.

Example: *“Even if you buy all the Affirmation’s arguments about how great the space program is, I would ask you to think about that initial observation I made: that if we increase funding in one area, we need to cut something else. If you have to cut education or food programs for Kindergartners to fund the space program, will it be worth it then?”*

2. If a topic or law being debated is so unique that the judge may not be aware of it, take a few moments to discuss the issue. You need the judge to know enough about the subject that he/she can understand the arguments you are making. A summary, if the topic is complicated or obscure, IS a productive use of time. For instance, if your topic was “ballast water,” would your judge know what that was? If you think not, then spend a minute giving background. A good rule of thumb: if you weren’t sure about the subject, then the judge probably isn’t either. But here’s a caution – when explaining difficult subject or giving background information, NEVER talk down to the judge. And NEVER talk about it for too long – that will use up valuable time to present your case.



3. Consider making two responses to a point, not just one. You say, “We have two responses to that argument.” Why do that? First, it already gets the judge thinking that you have a strong case. Also it requires the other side to ANSWER both of those responses. If they don’t answer them both, you can tell the judge that they DROPPED one of your responses. And remember you can number or letter your responses, just like in an

outline. “I have two responses – 1.2”. or “We would argue this is not the case. Subpoint A Subpoint B...” This helps the judge organize his/her notes.



4. Don't belabor a point. Sometimes, debaters overtalk a point, and it eats up valuable time. State your point succinctly, and then move on. I see a current trend of talking too fast in parli, but the winners seem to be those who slow the debate down and use a bit more oratorical style, a persuasive style. The debaters may speak more slowly and thus get in fewer arguments, but the judge is able to understand the arguments and the arguments stay with them.

5. Don't forget that you can pre-empt an argument. If you are pretty sure what the other side will argue, then present it first and answer it. For example, “Now the Negative is probably going to get up here and argue that the Status Quo is already handling water quality in this region. But here's what's important – we do it better. We will have tougher water standards to pass, we provide more money to get it done, we have tougher fines. In other words, we will be able to accomplish what the status quo can't.” Pre-empting arguments can take the wind out of the opposition and destroy their case.

Affirmation Tips:

There's an art to answering the Negation's attack on the Affirmation case. The 2nd Affirmation speaker really needs to be good at rebuilding the AFF case. Here are the steps:

Step 1: **Our first point was** State your point using the same words that your partner used or use a clearly understandable tag line.

Step 2: **Their response was** Keep this short – if you discuss their response for a long time, you're just reinforcing this argument in the mind of the judge, AND it ends up shortening the time you have to rebuild your argument.

Step 3: **However**..... explain your objection to their argument.

Step 4: **Let me explain**..... This is the crucial part. It is at this point where you explain clearly to the judge why their evidence, analysis, or logic is incorrect. The biggest mistake you can make is simply to repeat what has already been said by your partner. Repeating the same evidence OVER and OVER will not win the debate for you. Instead, you must EXTEND your argument. You must attack their response head on and poke all kinds of holes in it. You must present new evidence, new examples, new logic. You must rebuild your argument.

Step 5: **As a result**..... state that your harm still exists or your contention is still in tact and still provides an important reason to be for the resolution. And don't forget to emphasize your impact!

So how does that play out with a real argument? Take a look:

Example: *Our first point was WE SAVE LIVES. Their response was that the number of lives is not statistically significant. However, we would argue any lives saved is an improvement over the status quo. Let me explain, by implementing our plan, 1,000 lives could be saved by*

next year, and that's pretty significant – especially to the guy whose life is saved. The impact: we benefit more lives than they do.”

Negation Tips:

If you are arguing the definitions, you can argue that the definitions are UNREASONABLE and ABUSIVE. Take a look at what this debate site says: From <http://www.saskdebate.com>: “The first speaker must reasonably define key words in the resolution. The Affirmative shall not define the resolution in such a way as to give them a competitive advantage not inherent in the resolution. The definition must not be manipulated to produce a self-evident fact.”

If it is a policy debate, many Negative teams forget to attack the plan! This is usually the weakest area of the AFFs case, so go after it with gusto.

**PLAN
OF
ATTACK**

Rebuttal Advice

- Never forget to tie your voting arguments in with the judging criteria set up at the beginning. This is one of the most common mistakes with beginning debaters.
Example: *“At the beginning of this debate, we set up the voting criteria as “net benefits.” In other words, the team with the most benefits at the end of this debate should receive the win. So let’s look at the three benefits that the Affirmation carries.”*
- As you argue those winning arguments, be sure you help the judge see that each argument is unique and stands alone. In other words, it is NOT tied to any other argument. You want to make sure that if one of your arguments falls, that all the rest don’t fall in a domino effect. You tell the judge, “Each one of these arguments alone is enough to give our team the win.”
- Minimize the other side’s arguments. You can say, “Even if you buy the Affirmation’s arguments that the status quo is wasting some money, it’s not a significant argument. It is not a voting issue because they can’t guarantee that money won’t also be wasted by the Affirmative plan and because, while a small amount of money might be wasted, the benefits achieved far outweigh that loss.”
- In your Negative rebuttal, remember to pre-empt what you think might be the Affirmation’s voting issues. Minimize the importance of those arguments. You don’t get another chance to talk, so that last speech has to guess at what the Affirmation will bring up.
- Keep the rebuttal simple. **DON’T JUMP AROUND THE FLOW.** You say, “We’ve now had a chance to hear all the arguments presented in this debate. We believe that there are three voting issues presented and the Affirmation has won them all. Number one _____.”

Chapter 18

There's No Better Time Than the Present! (Or Going to your First tournament)

You've now learned the basics, but now you need to try them out in a real debate setting. Yes, the time has come – you need to go to your first tournament! Tournaments can be stressful the first time you go, but there's no better way to learn to debate than to test your skills in competition. In order to prepare for your first tournament, read the questions and answers below to learn what you can expect.

Who goes to these tournaments?

There will probably be about 20 to 30 schools sending students to the tournament. You will find anywhere from 200 to 500 students there. Usually several events are run at every debate tournament. Not all the people there will be doing parli debate.

What do we do to get ready for this tournament?

It takes some advance planning on your part. Don't wait until the morning of the tournament to get organized.

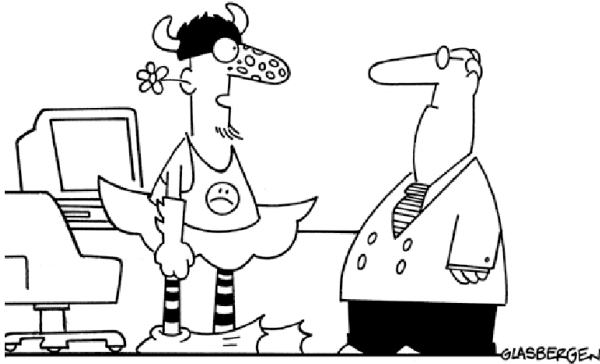
TABROOM – First and foremost, get yourself signed up on Tabroom.com. All the important information from tournament headquarters happens through Tabroom. This is where you find out when you are debating, who you are debating, where you are debating, and what topic you are debating! In other words, EVERYTHING comes through Tabroom. You will need to make sure you have an account with them, and you will need to create a password. Our officers will help you get set up, but it must be done the week BEFORE the tournament. (Also note: if you have parents judging, you must help them get a Tabroom account, as well.)

READ AND MAKE A COPY OF THE MATERIAL YOUR COACHES HAVE SENT YOU ABOUT THIS TOURNAMENT -- Look over and READ the material, and record where and when you are to meet the next day.

GET YOUR SUPPLIES READY – Gather all your supplies into a backpack and set them into the car you will use in the morning. Be sure you have your pens and pencils, some playing cards, your laptop or tablet, some cash, your cell phone, your charging cord, and any pressing homework. You do have some “dow time” at the tournament. Make sure all electronics are **FULLY CHARGED!**



CHOOSE WHAT YOU WILL WEAR AND SET IT OUT -- The night before, you need to get your outfit ready to go. Girls, you need a skirt or nice pants, nice blouse, and a blazer, if possible. If you stick with debate, you'll probably want to get a suit. Try to find a place where you can add some color to your outfit (in the blouse, a scarf etc.– you want the judge to remember you. Girls should wear a



"I am dressed for success! Of course, my idea of success may not be exactly the same as yours."

a little make-up; having color in your cheeks and on your lips makes you look better to the judge.

Gentlemen, you will need nice slacks, a shirt, belt, and tie. Like the girls, if you stick with debate, you'll want to get a suit. You also should find a place to add some color to your outfit. Consider a colorful (not gaudy) tie, a shirt with color, or a pocket handkerchief with pattern or color.

Outfits should be CLEAN and PRESSED – judges look at your appearance and it helps them remember who you

Wear deodorant and brush your teeth. Bring a comb or brush and possibly a toothbrush. You **MUST** be well groomed at the tournament. And take a moment part way through the tournament to freshen up. Check your hair. Check your clothing. Tuck in your shirt. In other words, check in the mirror before you leave home.

Also consider bringing comfortable shoes. You will be hiking around quite a bit, and your feet can get sore. Switch into the comfortable shoes between rounds.



MAKE YOUR LUNCH OR BRING SOME \$ FOR FOOD -- Bring foods that won't leave a stain on your clothes if the food happens to land on you. No foods that stick to your teeth. No foods that have strong smells or can cause bad breath. Bring some midday snacks – debating takes energy, and a few snacks can refuel your brain. Bring lots to drink – you'll want to stay hydrated. But once again, consider simple water or CLEAR liquids. You don't want it to stain if you spill. Just remember – it's not a good thing if the judge can tell what you had to eat by looking at the front of your outfit! You can usually buy food, but I think it's best to bring it with you, at least for the first tournament.

When and where do we meet?

Read the email for each tournament to see where to meet. Don't assume that it will always be the same place. Always be on time!

What do we do when you get there?

As you leave the car, check to make sure you have everything with you. Also help to carry team supplies. Next, you will find the area where all the students are gathering, usually a cafeteria or student center. Our team will stake out a place. It is here that you will spend the day. Once there, you will get out your debate supplies and set up shop. Then you wait for the first posting.

What if we have a problem?

Talk with some of the students from our team who have been to a tournament before about your issue. Check with other kids from other schools. And you can always come find the coach or parent in charge. They are generally in the coaches' room. They will also carry their cell phones with them, and you can call them. The biggest issue is NOT TO PANIC. If you can't find your coach, go to the coaches' room and ask another coach. Bottom line – all our students have survived AND ENJOYED their first tournament. It may seem a little scary at first, but you will get the hang of it.



When and where do we get our topics?

Most debate tournaments start around 8:45. The tournament directors will post the debate pairings on Tabroom, and usually you will get an email. The posting will tell you whether you are Affirmation or Negation, what team you will be facing, whether you are Flight A or Flight B, and in what room you will debate. You will also get the topic. Be sure to write it down EXACTLY on your flow sheet. Some students like to take a picture of the postings and the topic with their cell phones.

What do they mean by "Flight A and Flight B"?

First, we're NOT talking airplanes here. Most of the time the tournament directors will hold two debates in each room during a single round. Flight A debaters will get their topic first and they will debate in that room first. Flight B teams will get their topics about 20 to 30 minutes later and will debate in that same room later. Their debate topic will be different from Flight A. The same judge will be in that room the whole time, judging the Flight A debate first and then the Flight B debate. If you are Flight B, make sure that Flight A is over before entering the room. If you need to open the door to check, do it quietly.



What happens during our prep time?

First, set your timers so you know when your 20 minutes is up. You and your partner will then begin to prepare for the debate. You will work in the main room, and you will not leave until dismissed. Immediately head to the room where you are assigned to judge.

Write your arguments on your flow sheet. You CANNOT use any other materials **during** the debate other than your notes. You cannot open your laptop or books DURING the debate, so get all the key points written on that flow sheet. Don't forget to put down cite references on your notes.

Can we work with other people on our team?

Yes, you can. Novice and JV debate teams can coordinate together. (Only varsity teams must work by themselves.) But remember, sometimes you will be in different flights and have different topics.

What if we don't know anything about the topic?

First thing to remember is that this doesn't happen very often. Next, remember not to panic.

Talk with school teammates first – someone will know something; then go on the Internet. Check an online dictionary if the resolution has words you don't know. Look for articles that may be useful. As a last resort, check ChatGPT. BUT be careful not to become dependent on ChatGPT, please.

Should we bring anything other than our notes to use in the round?

Bring a watch to use as a timer. Bring some post-it notes, so you can write notes to your partner if you need to. Bring pens. And bring a copy of the National Parliamentary Debate League rules (found in the Addendum of this book.) You should have read these rules over and understand them well. If you think something has been done wrong, you can reference the rules with the other team and the judge. And bring anything of value with you – don't leave it in the prep room. For instance, your laptop. If you aren't allowed to use it during the round, just set it aside, don't open it etc. But for safety sake, you don't want it left unguarded in the prep room.

Who will watch our debates? Will it be a big audience? In the room, you will have your team, the other team, the judge, and maybe an observer or two. That's all – only 5 to 7 people in the room.!

When do we go to our assigned room? A few minutes before the 20 minute prep time is up, you will be dismissed to head to your room. Check carefully inside the room to see what is happening before barging in. A debate may still be going on inside the room. Wait outside the room until the judge



arrives or until the debate going on inside is over. Do NOT interrupt anyone speaking in the room. Check to see if the judge is ready for you. If not, wait outside. If the other team doesn't arrive soon, check to make sure you are in the right place. If no judge arrives to your room, then one member of each team needs to go to the coaches' room and check on things. Use any free time outside the room to continue to prepare – every second of preparation counts. Once inside, set up. Do NOT touch anything in the rooms other than what you need. Treat the room with respect. Your coaches NEVER want to get a report that anyone on your team did anything destructive in the room.

Pull 2 desks to the front and face them toward the back of the room where the judge will be. (Notice where you got them because you need to put them back in the same place) Put away any prep books, computers, and anything that shows the school name. Judges are NOT to know what school you are from.

Next, write your names on the board like this – if the tournament says it is OK:

1AC Joe Smith or 1NC Mary Johnson OR 2AC Kate Riley 2NC Bill Anders

Have the member of your team with the best handwriting do this job. Write NEATLY and BIG so that the judge has a first good impression of your team. You or the other team should write the exact wording of the topic on the board for the judge to see – again, write it big and make it neat.

When the other team arrives, greet them in a friendly way. Be confident with them. Do NOT discuss schools with them. When the judge arrives, be polite but get down to business. Give the judge a minute to get settled. Say to the judge, "Let us know when you are ready for us to begin."

Is there anything to remember during the debate?

BE POLITE. ACT PROFESSIONALLY. No eye rolling, no sarcasm, no negative non-verbal communication. ACT CONFIDENTLY. Your performance can sometimes be as important as your argument so your speech DELIVERY is extremely important.

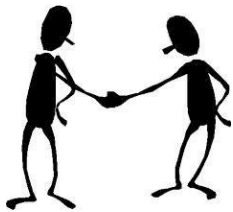
What is meant by “Judging Preferences?”

Sometimes teams will ask the judge, “What are your judging preferences?” That means, is there anything the judge would like you to do or keep in mind as you debate. Judges often say things like, “Clear organization is important to me” or “I don’t like a fast speaking style” or “This is my first time judging so keep that in mind.”

If a judge gives you judging preferences, you better debate with that in mind. If they like it organized, then clearly number your points. If they like it slow, then keep your pace slow even if it means you need to cut a point short. And if they are new to debate, don’t use debate lingo or abbreviations; also provide history on issues they might not know.

It looks very bad if you disregard the judges preferences! They have clearly told you what they will judge you on, so to disregard it is likely to lose you the debate.

When the debate is over, what do we do?



First, you go shake the hands of the other team and thank them for the debate. Next, you go over to the judge and shake their hand with a friendly, but firm handshake. (A limp handshake does not send the message of confidence.) Thank them for giving up their time to judge the debate. If the judge doesn’t seem to want to shake hands (a lasting reminder of Covid), just thank them. Some judges may be worried about germs.

Do NOT ever ask the judge what his/her decision is. Do NOT ever ask the judge for ways to improve. Leave the judge alone as soon as possible so that he/she can finish writing the ballot. Even if you see the judge later outside the room, you are NOT to discuss the debate. It might look like you are trying to influence the judge.

As soon as the handshaking is over, you will put the desks back, erase the board, and gather up your stuff. You should leave the room looking as neat or neater than you found it. Do NOT discuss the debate while cleaning up the room. Exit the room as soon as you are done cleaning up. Then head back to the main area to wait for the next round. Be sure to check that you have not left anything behind.

How many rounds will we do?

For most of our contests, you will do 3 - 4 rounds in one day. At some of our invitationals, you will go even more than that. There will be free time between each round.



Round 3

How well do you think that we should do on our very first tournament?

Here are the expectations of most coaches – that each team will make it to each of their rounds to debate (not getting lost along the way) and that each team will learn some new things about debate

during the day. We don't expect you to win any debates – if you win one, that is a bonus. Remember, you are brand new at this – you will debate some students who have been doing this awhile. So go easy on yourself! Your coaches just want you to gain experience and absorb how things are done – you will be amazed how much you learn at just one tournament

How do we find out our results?

There will be an awards ceremony. They usually announce the teams that had 2-1 and 3-0 records. All those teams will move up a division. The judge's comment sheets for each round will usually go up online within a day after the tournament. And each team should look at their comment sheets – sometimes they don't say much, but sometimes they give you REALLY GOOD information about how your team can improve. For example, if you see that 3 judges wrote that you were disorganized, then you clearly know that improving organization needs to be a top priority!

Chapter 19

Armchair Debating – From the Comfort of your own Home



With Covid having reared its ugly head and more schools unable to sponsor big tournaments, online tournaments are here to stay. What does that mean? It means you will debate via computers and laptops in your house or school rather than in an actual room. So how do you prepare for an online tournament? Here are some

pointers:

In the Weeks Leading Up to the Tournament

1. Be sure you have signed up with your partner for the tournament.
2. Go to Tabroom and register – if you haven't already done so.
3. Decide whether you will prep with your partner in one of your homes or if you will prep by yourselves in different locations. When asked, our students said they preferred to be in the same location, and we recommend that!

The Night Before the Tournament

1. Make sure all devices are charged, that you have more than one device at your disposal, and that you know where to plug them in. It is also good to have a back-up battery pack. Remember a power outage could occur, so those devices need to be usable without external power.
2. Decide in which room you will debate. Try to imagine what the judge will see in the background and clean up that area. Make your background non-distracting. Pick a room where you won't have to deal with noise from the family TV or loud music from your brother's room. Also check the lighting in the room. For instance, having a window behind you will put you into the shadow.
3. Get your clothes ready. Just because you are at home doesn't mean you can dress in a messy fashion. All the rules for dressing still apply. Remember the people who got caught during Covid wearing professional attire on top and pajamas on the bottom? Awkward!
4. Don't forget to gather any other resources and supplies you use and put them in the area where you will be debating. Items might include paper, pens, timer, materials your coach has given you etc.
5. Make sure you have your coach's telephone, email and text number at your computer. You never know when you will have a problem and need to reach your coach ASAP.
6. Go to Tabroom and find the Schedule for the next day's tournament. Print it out or save it to favorites so that you can access it immediately. Note the time for the first draw of the day and the starting for the first round.



First Thing in the Morning

1. Get set up.
2. Text your coach 15 minutes before the tournament starts to tell her/him that you and your partner are ready to go.
3. Turn on your computers, check that everything is working, and practice making sure where you will stand in order to be picked up on the camera. You don't want your head cut off etc.
4. Turn on Tabroom to be ready to get the topic call out

Prepping and Debating

1. Prepping will be the same as you would prep during an in-person tournament.
2. 5 minutes before the round is supposed to start you need to go online and check into your Zoom room.
3. Don't commit these Zoom mistakes.
 - DON'T forget to put yourself on MUTE when you're not speaking. Remember, when you aren't speaking, keep your computer/ipad on mute. That way you can talk to your partner while the other team is speaking.
 - DON'T have a MESSY or DISTRACTING BACKGROUND
 - Watch facial expression during the debate. Just because you aren't the one speaking doesn't mean the judge can't see you. No non-verbal communication.
 - Look at the camera lens and not the people on the screen. If you talk to the people on the screen, it will seem like you are looking down. Instead, find the camera and look into it. You might want to put a post-it near the camera lens so that you remember.
 - DON'T eat or drink while the debate is going on.
 - Use plenty of vocal and facial variety – Zoom can be boring, and you can fall into the trap of sounding/looking boring. Stay animated.
4. Be sure to thank the judge for judging before you leave the Zoom room.
5. You are now free until the next round. Check what time the next round topic will be announced and what time the debate is supposed to start.

At the End of the Tournament

1. There will be an awards assembly at the end of the tournament. Check on Tabroom for the link to the Awards assembly.
2. Once the ballots have been downloaded, you should read what the judges have written, and you and your partner need to discuss what areas where you need to improve.

Chapter 20

Judgment Day: What Judges Look For When Making their Decisions



One of the great philosophical questions asks,

"If a tree falls in the forest, and no one is around to hear it, did it make a sound?"

I would alter this question slightly to make it a bit more meaningful for you, the parli debater:

If a debater makes an argument, and the judge doesn't hear it, did the debater actually make that argument?

Let's be honest – in the end, the judge's decision is all that matters. If he/she doesn't hear an argument because

1. you were so boring that the judge didn't listen,
 2. you talked too fast for the judge to catch it, or
 3. you didn't explain it clearly enough for the judge to understand it,
- then your argument "fell on deaf ears!" It is as if you didn't make that argument at all!

In the end, you don't need to persuade the other team that you won – you just need to persuade the judge. So keep the judge ALWAYS in your mind. Here are a few rules of etiquette and some common sense ideas to remember when interacting with your judge:

1. Be polite and respectful towards your judge.
2. Talk TO the judge – make eye contact.
3. Connect with the judge – smile.
4. Thank the judge at the end of the debate and shake his or her hand.
5. NEVER ask the judge for his or her decision. NEVER ask for feedback on the debate unless a tournament specifically says that you can.

6. NEVER discuss the debate within the judge's hearing. And if you are prepping for the debate in the room while the judge has already arrived, do NOT say anything that might tell the judge that you aren't prepared etc.
7. Watch the judge's face – it will often reveal how your judge is understanding the debate.
8. Check to see if the judge is flowing the debate – if they aren't, that is a signal to “take it down a notch” and speak more slowly.
9. NEVER assume that a judge knows “debate jargon.” Don't use abbreviations like POI or AFF or PROP. You may be confusing them.
10. Never assume the judge knows everything about the subject you are discussing. For instance, if your topic is the Glass-Steagal act or is a topic on “ballast water discharge,” (yes, these are topics we have had), your judge may be clueless. It is worth giving up a little speech time to give some history and/or background on your topic. This should be done right after giving the definitions. The judge will appreciate it.
11. Check before the debate to see if a judge has written a paradigm. The paradigm will tell you lots about how the judge will judge the debate. It will often tell you the judge's experience level and knowledge of parliamentary debate. It will tell you what the judge likes and doesn't like to see and hear in a debate. Usually the paradigms are found under the judge's name on Tabroom. And once you know the judge's preferences, you should tailor your style, speed etc. to fit those preferences.

And one more piece of advice: Always try to know the judging rules that a judge has been given. They will be using the judging guidelines to determine who wins and loses the debate.

These are the judging guidelines given to our Golden Gate Speech Association parli judges.

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1zLi7SuAikagQqIHgLTercgN20MqCNJKk75qffgD73E/edit?tab=t.0#heading=h.c0ewy1r505ph>

Part 2 – Running with the Big Dogs!

If you are reading Part 2, it probably means that you are hooked on parliamentary debate and may even have racked up some wins! You probably understand the basics of parliamentary debate, but you're also starting to realize that you need to learn more so you can compete at a more advanced level. If that's the case, you're ready to explore some tougher, more sophisticated concepts. In this section of the book, we will be tackling many of the more complex ideas that you need to know in order to "run with the big dogs!"

Chapter 21

Weighing In – Tipping the Scales in your Favor!

A Closer Look at the Weighing Mechanism



Your judge's job is to decide who wins the debate, and your job is to give him/her a way to decide who wins. Enter the **WEIGHING MECHANISM**. This is where you provide the criteria or combination of criteria that the judge should rely on. You are comparing for the judge the impacts presented within the rounds.

Earlier in this book, we gave you the basic criteria (net benefits, preponderance of evidence, moral imperative etc.), but now it's time to go a little deeper. Often the **AFF** will suggest one criteria on which to decide the debate and the **NEG** will come back with another. So which one is the judge to select? Your job, should you decide to accept it (which, of course, you must!), is to provide the judge with a method to weigh which standard is better, which one should be used.

Let's face it – sometimes both sides have good arguments, and the judge has to decide which one is more important on the scale of importance. You may argue, for instance, your plan will eliminate some jobs but will be better overall for the climate, while the other side argues that it will cost jobs and ultimately cause a significant decline in the economy. Both are true, so which should the judge choose to tip the debate in your favor?

Where in the debate do you really weigh these arguments and let the judge know which of these "truths" is **MORE IMPORTANT** and should swing the debate over to you? The rebuttal, of course. That's what makes the rebuttal so important – it is in this speech that you explain to the judge why your arguments are so much better and should give you the win. Let's see how to effectively set up your weighing mechanism in the rebuttal:

1. Set up a standard or new concept to decide which argument to accept. Consider this expanded list of common criteria: cost-benefit analysis, security, well being, justice, fairness, and freedom can be used. Philosophic standards can also be introduced such as utilitarianism, the social contract, or society values. (See Addendum 6 for more details on these.) Which one best fits your impacts? That's the one to choose.

2. Now provide an analysis of the standard. Should you ask the judge to weigh it based on:
 - a. **Magnitude** – How big/important is the impact? Which team has the bigger impact?
 - b. **Scope** – How many things/people are affected? Who saves more lives?
 - c. **Reversibility** – Can an effect be undone?
 - d. **Time Frame** – When can you guarantee it will happen? How long will it take to implement? One element of this is **urgency** – How desperately do we need it done now? And the other is **overall time** to implement something
 - e. **Probability** – How likely is it that something will really happen?
 - f. **Severity** – How extreme, serious, or harsh is this going to be?

All of these deal with how good or bad the impacts will be on the nation or the world. So when both impacts can happen, weigh the impacts in light of the above and help the judge see how your analysis is the best.

3. Analyze the other side's and your impacts through the standards you have set. Show how your points are more important.

Remember, a good job of weighing the debate during the rebuttal can be the MOST important element in helping you WIN that all important ballot.



Chapter 22

Hold On a Minute – Plan B Has Just Entered the Building! The Negative Counterplan

(This is generally a synopsis on counterplans condensed from the book, *On That Point!: An Introduction to Parliamentary Debate* by Kate Shuster and John Meany.)

In most parliamentary debates, when the resolution is a policy topic, the proposition team (AFF) must advocate for a change in the status quo and presents a plan to do that. And in most parli debates, the negation argues that no change is necessary, that the status quo is able to handle the problem.

But here's a new thought: the negation is not limited to just defending the status quo. The negation can present a COUNTERPLAN (a CP).



What is a **COUNTERPLAN**? It is a proposal offered by the negation that provides a reason to reject the proposition team's plan and presents what it believes to be a superior plan. The negation essentially says, "If we adopted the Proposition plan, it would interfere with other potential plans that might work better." The counterplan should be presented in the 1NC in order to be fair to the AFF. Ultimately, the purpose of the counterplan is to replace the AFF team's plan by providing a benefit that the AFF plan fails to provide.

Let's say your friend is hungry and suggests that you go get hamburgers. But you suggest that Chinese food is a better idea. Both plans compete for the same money and the same time. Now your job is to show that your counterplan for Chinese food is a better way to solve your hunger problem.

And remember this: Once the AFF reads their plan, the AFF cannot change or SEVER it. Don't let them add elements to their plan as a way of attacking your counterplan!



Sounds easy to run a counter plan, right? **Here's the catch:** By suggesting a counterplan, you are ADMITTING that the status quo has HARMS that need to be addressed. In other words, you have given the Affirmation half their case – you have agreed to the harms that they have presented. That's huge! So you need to think carefully before presenting a counterplan.



And here's the other catch – You don't know what the Affirmation plan will be until the debate gets going. What if they run as their plan the SAME thing you were planning to run as a counterplan. Do NOT use counterplans unless the wording of the resolution almost DEMANDS what the AFF plan should be. For example, if the motion was "the U.S. government should require all cars be hybrids by 2020," it would be pretty easy to run a counterplan. You could be almost 100% certain what the Affirmation's plan would be about. But if the resolution is "The U.S. should significantly reduce its carbon footprint," the topic is much broader and has many possible plan options. As the negation, you would have no idea what

kind of a plan the AFF will suggest, so this would not be a good topic for running a counterplan.

So even after these warnings, if you decide to run a counterplan, as the negation, you need to show that the proposition team's plan is bad (hamburgers are high in calories and are bad for your health) and that your plan is better (Chinese food is lower in cholesterol and calories). You get the judge to believe that your plan will BETTER solve the harms presented.

A counterplan must force a choice between two proposals and must compete with the proposition plan. In a counterplan, you:

1. Present your counterplan. – It should include the same elements as an Affirmation plan: Who will do it (the actor), what will they do (the mandate), when will they do it (timeline), how will they implement it (the enforcement), and how will they finance it. For example if the AFF resolution is to “move to 100% electric cars by 2040,” you could suggest moving to 100% use of steam powered cars. See how these two plans are mutually exclusive – both could not happen simultaneously!
2. Next, after presenting the plan, you MUST tell the judge how your plan is COMPETITIVE. The NEG has a responsibility to make their CP competitive with the AFFs plan. This means that the counterplan either PHYSICALLY cannot or FUNCTIONALLY should not co-exist with the AFF plan. There are a couple of ways to make a CP competitive. The Negative is saying, “It’s our way or the highway.”
 - You can do this by showing that your plan is MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE – in other words if one plan exists, the other cannot exist at the same time! If a company’s plan is to permit shorts to be worn in the workplace, you couldn’t have a regulation that only allows long pants in the workplace. These couldn’t exist at the same time, and thus they are mutually exclusive.
 - You can also do this by showing the “net benefits” of your plan. You can show that the AFF plan causes something bad to happen, but the counterplan avoids the bad element from happening. If both the AFF and NEG’s plans happen together, then the bad element of the AFF plan will still happen. Therefore, the two plans should not FUNCTIONALLY co-exist. In other words, show the judge that, in balance, your counterplan has more benefits than the Affirmation plan. You can show NET BENEFITS by arguing that the counterplan is a GOOD idea because it has advantages that ONLY come from the counterplan – it has advantages that the proposition plan doesn’t have. What you are saying is, “Don’t vote for the proposition’s plan, because if you do, you will forgo this superior policy option.” You essentially argue that when you adopt the proposition’s plan, you forgo other opportunities that might be better – some teams call this the “**opportunity cost**.”

Example: If your friend decides it is best to DRIVE to the movies, you argue that other opportunities are lost – can’t go by bus, dogsled, bicycle, or skateboard – and they might be better than the car choice.



Legislators have to make choices between different and competing plans all the time. When they have a finite amount of resources available to solve a problem, legislators must choose between several options. When you present a counterplan, your judge (just like the legislators) will have that job of choosing whether the Affirmation or the Negation has presented the best plan. As the Negation, you show him/her that the affirmation plan is bad because it requires giving up the negation's plan, which is more beneficial – has more net benefits. In effect, you're telling the judge our plan ***beats the socks off the Affirmation's plan.***

Chapter 23

If The Shoe Fits, Wear It – Standards Types of Counterplans to Try On

Are there some typical counterplans that you can use? You bet there are – they are known as “generic” counterplans.

1. **The “AGENT” counterplan** -- All plans have an “agent of action” – a group, department, or body that is put in place to carry out the plan. Usually it is a branch or department of the federal government. In an AGENT counterplan you argue that the agent the Affirmation has chosen is not good – that you have another agent who will do it, and that agent will do a FAR better job. Of course, this means that you need good evidence that their agent is 1) ineffective, 2) costly, 3) not designed for the job, 4) over-burdened by other jobs, or 5) a combination. And you need to prove that your agent can do it MUCH better AND still solve the harms presented by the Affirmation.



Example: *The Affirmation says that the U.S. federal government will provide free malaria medications to children to halt malaria. You attack their agent (the U.S. federal government) and present a counterplan to have it done by the World Health Organization. (This is a global/international agent rather than a federal gov agent.)*

In order to run this kind of counterplan, it is a good idea to have a list of commonly used agents of action and generate why each is a BAD agent. Then generate arguments about why each of these might also be a good one. (This is sort of a Pro/Con look at agents of action.) Now, you’ll always be prepared to present an “AGENT” counterplan.

One agent counterplan is “state versus federal government.” If the Affirmation wants the federal government to do it, you present a counterplan to have the states run it, saying that the decentralized approach is better, that states are better positioned (via efficiency, experimentation, enforcement, knowledge of their own states needs etc.) to do it better. And if they Affirmation is having individual states do it, your counterplan is to have the federal government do it instead because they are more central, they provide uniformity throughout the nation, and/or they can better finance it etc. You could also do a “federal vs. International” agent counterplan.

Notice that an agent counterplan is automatically “mutually exclusive” -- you can’t have both the U.S. and the states doing the same plan at the same time.

2. **The “PROCESS” counterplan** (AKA the STUDY or CONSULTATION counterplan) – This counterplan implements the affirmative’s plan through a different process or a different way. In this counterplan, you might say that more study is necessary before making a final decision,

that a referendum is needed, that you need to consult another group before making a final decision, or that it should be implemented through a Congressional override.

You argue that we don't know enough about 1) the harms, 2) the best way to proceed, or 3) all the options that might be available. You claim that the Affirmation is locking us into a plan BEFORE we have all the facts. You argue that it would be harmful for the U.S. to adopt the Affirmation plan without more study or without consulting someone with more direct information.



Your counterplan, then, is to set up a study or consult with a group before committing the U.S. to anything. Again, note that this is mutually exclusive. You can't put a plan into effect at the same time you are doing a study or are consulting.

3. ***The Plan-Inclusive Counterplan (PIC)*** – With this CP, the Negative keeps some but not all of the AFF plan elements. You get rid of the elements that are disadvantageous/bad and keep the best ones. This is sometimes called the Severance Counterplan. These are very effective counterplans since they can still solve the AFF's harms, but the NEG CP gets rid of an important disadvantage. You may have heard the old adage, "Don't throw out the baby with the bathwater." With the PIC plan, you throw out the disadvantages (bathwater) but keep the best parts of AFF plan (the baby.)

4. The Advantage or Solvency Counterplan – The NEG decides to solve the Affirmative's harms through a different, better method that is outside the topic. The NEG is essentially offering another alternative to solve the harm. In this type of counterplan, the NEGATIVE goes in an opposite direction from the Affirmation, saying that this different direction will SOLVE for the harms presented better than the Affirmation's plan. If the Affirmation argues that more government regulation is the best solution to environmental pollution, you, as the Negation, run a CP that says that deregulation would be better. You offer a counterplan that contains this element. Several of these "opposite direction" options come to mind:



- | | |
|-----------------------------------|--|
| **Regulation versus deregulation | **Unilateral versus multilateral |
| **Criminal versus civil penalties | **Compulsory versus voluntary incentives |

But it doesn't just have to be opposites. Sometimes the CP offered by the NEG will be a completely different way of solving the harm.

Example Let's say the topic is on setting new age limits for e-bikes. The AFF recommends that, because younger students are often injured when riding e-bikes, they propose a plan prohibiting students from using e-bikes under the age of 16. The NEG presents an advantage counterplan that says that instead all students must

attend a safety class on e-bikes and get an e-bike license. They say this plan will solve the problem of injuries, and they will gain several NET BENEFITS, which are 1. It insures that kids know the rules of the road, and 2. It helps working parents who currently can't get their kids to school. Their plan is outside the topic area

Does this advantage counterplan tick all the boxes?



- It differs from the Affirmative plan
- It is outside the resolution
- It solves the harm presented by the Affirmation's case
- It achieves a net benefit that the AFF plan does not have

Bottom line: A counterplan must be competitive: it must be mutually exclusive and it must be net-beneficial to do the CP rather than the Affirmative plan. A Negative must convince the judge of these two elements or they can't win.

Chapter 24

So What's an Affirmation Team to do? Countering the Counterplan



It is important to remember that, when the Negation presents a counterplan, they have handed you, the Affirmation, a huge part of your case on a silver platter. They have AGREED that the harms you presented DO EXIST and need solving. Think about that – all those contentions you presented – the Negation has handed them to you, and you can mark them on your flow sheet as going to the Affirmation. **BE SURE TO TELL THE JUDGE THIS!**

Now all you have to do is show that your plan is better than their plan for solving for the harms! That sounds a bit easier, doesn't it?

The second AFF needs to remember— a counterplan is really just another plan presented by the NEG. As such, a counterplan can be attacked just the way that an AFF plan can be attacked. Let's say the resolution is that "Danton should purchase a new car." The NEG introduces a counterplan to have Danton buy a used car. Let's attack that counter plan:

- ★ **Is it workable?** Are there used car dealers in the area? Does the town Danton lives in have reliable repair shops? Can he get a loan to buy a used car as easily as he can get one for a new car?
- ★ **Is the counterplan vague?** The counterplan needs to be specific. Why would we adopt a counterplan that is vague? For instance, in the counterplan to have Danton buy a used car, – does the CP how much Danton can spend, does the CP set up what Danton should do if can't find a used car to fit his needs, how much mileage should be on the used car, does the CP have a fund for repairs (which will be more frequent with an old car vs. a new), does the CP mandate a safety inspection?
- ★ **Do they really solve for the harms presented?** If one of the AFFs harms is that Danton doesn't have a reliable way to get to work, can the CP really guarantee that a used car will give him that reliability or is it likely to break down more?
- ★ **Does it create new disadvantages?** This is really important. If it creates disadvantages that are NEW and SPECIFIC to their counterplan, you need to hammer this. In Danton's case, the used car might create more smog, be noisier, or when it breaks down, leave Danton stranded in an unsafe location, all of which are disadvantages.
- ★ **Is there a funding disadvantage?** Sure Danton's car costs less upfront, but with repair costs more frequent, the cost could be significant. And buying new cars stimulate the economy, which is better for everyone.

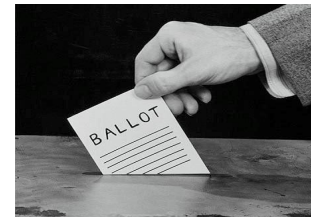
Here are some strategies to use to attack the Negative Counterplan

1.. Use a Permutation to Attack the Negative Counterplan: Remember permutations? A perm is an argument that tests the competitiveness of the counterplan plan by telling the judge that both the AFF plan and the counterplan can exist AT THE SAME TIME. It does this by saying, “You can do both the plan and counterplan simultaneously – they aren’t mutually exclusive.”

Let’s say the topic is on energy alternatives. The AFFs plan proposes we use solar energy. The NEG counterplan says, “No, we want to use WIND energy, and it will be better. The AFF perm for this is that the NEG plan is not mutually exclusive – we could do BOTH solar energy and wind energy simultaneously, thus working to benefit all parties!

Why is that a BIG deal? Remember, the negation has the BURDEN to present reasons to reject the Affirmation’s plan, and the counterplan must be COUNTER to the plan. So here’s the Affirmation’s logical argument -- if both plans can be done

TOGETHER, then the negation has failed to present a compelling reason showing why the Affirmation plan should be rejected. Their counterplan does NOT provide a reason to vote against the Affirmation. That’s a VOTING issue, my friends, and that means the Affirmation wins!



2. Argue that the Negation counterplan does NOT have the ability to solve for the harms you presented. Just as the Negation looks at solvency with the Affirmation plan, the Affirmation must do this with the Negative counterplan. Argue that it doesn’t solve the harms presented in this debate or that it doesn’t solve the harms as well as the AFF plan does. And you can weigh the impacts from your advantages against the counterplans’ impacts.

3. Argue that the counterplan will not be equally advantageous, that the counterplan is not NET BENEFICIAL. Let them know that the AFF offers some advantages that the NEG counterplan doesn’t have. Why would we go with a counterplan that is not at least as or more advantageous than the AFF. So here is where weighing the NET BENEFITS becomes VERY important.

Earlier we looked at some generic counterplans. You can use some clear defense strategies to defeat those type of stock counterplans –

1. Your defense for their AGENT counterplan -- If their counterplan does not specifically say who enacts the plan, then run an A-Spec or “Agent Specification” argument. With an A-Spec, you argue that the NEG counterplan does not have an agent or that the AFF has a superior agent. Of course, that means you will need to be able to defend the agent you, the AFF, have chosen. You need to have clear reasons why your agent is the BEST. You need to argue that the agent the Negation chose is BAD and will create MANY disadvantages. At the end, tell the judge to look at the net benefits – your agent is the best and will result in more benefits and fewer disadvantages than the Negation’s chosen agent.
2. Your defense for the STUDY or CONSULTATION counterplan -- Show that there is NO NEED FOR A STUDY or for prolonged consultations. Argue that a study or consultation would take too

long, meanwhile all the harms you presented would still be happening, and those harms need to be addressed NOW. The Affirmative gets the advantages SOONER! Finally, argue that the findings of the study or consultation will be biased and flawed. Who will choose or appoint the members to conduct the study or who are the group you will consult with, what are their qualifications, do they owe favors to anyone etc.? This could result in many Neg Disads!

3. Your defense for the EXCLUSIONARY counterplan -- Remember, in this counterplan, the NEG gets rid of or excludes some element of the AFF plan, saying it is bad. So as the Affirmative team you must first and foremost, initially write a good plan – try to think about the arguments the Negation might bring up. Don't put in mandates that you can't defend. Avoid words like "ALL" or "EVERYONE" or "100%." Look for weaknesses BEFORE you present your plan. In this case, the best offense is a good defense. If you have done this, the NEG won't find some element that they want to exclude. Remember, when the Negation does an exclusionary counterplan, they have handed you (agreed to) your entire plan EXCEPT for one element – the element they want to exclude. So now you don't need to debate the entire plan, you just need to justify the one element they object to. The Negation needs to prove that the plan is really better without that one element – the burden of proof is on them!



So Affirmation team, don't get cold feet when you hear the negation say, "We have a counterplan." **Counterplans can be defeated!!**

Chapter 25

Tech and Theory in Parliamentary Debate – We Aren’t Talking Computers Here!



“Tech” or “theory” debate involves several elements of debate that are filtering down from policy debate and are finding their way into parliamentary debate. A theory or technical debate is **a debate about debate**, specifically about the rules that surround how we debate. One side argues that we should (or should not) debate a certain way to keep the debate fair and educational. It is an argument about the rules and norms of debate. In this kind of debate, a team proposes a “theory shell.” A “shell” is a structured, formatted argument that claims the other side broke an unwritten rule, norm or definition. It is sort of like throwing a challenge flag in football. When this happens, the game can’t continue until the challenge is decided. When you present a theory argument you are saying that deciding the rules and ensuring fairness in the debate is the BIGGEST priority and must be decided first! The team offering a theory shell will explain why the opposing team violated a rule or norm and why this is bad for fairness and education in the debate. And of course, it isn’t enough to say a rule has been broken, the team needs to say why the rule is important and what the punishment for breaking the rule should be.

A theory shell format should have 4 parts.

- Interpretation – the team simply states the rule they think should be followed in the debate. It is essentially the way your team believes the debate should be run. For example, “Teams shouldn’t paraphrase” or “the term ‘federal government’ needs greater specificity before we can proceed.” Sometimes a team will put forth a frivolous theory shell like “Debates should take off their shoes in order to debate effectively.”
- Violation of Standard – the team specifically states what the opponent did to violate the rule; it explains how the other team does not conform to the Interpretation.
- Internal link – the team explains why their interpretation is good for the debate and why it matters. They explain why it would be bad not to accept their interpretation
- Voter – The team tells the judge why they need to care about all of this. It is a form of weighing the argument for the judge. Things like:
 - Fairness– not fair because both teams don’t have an equal opportunity to win
 - Predictability – not fair because the other team did not keep the debate within predictable bounds, and there was no way for your team to prepare within the 20 minutes for the way they are interpreting things
 - education – not good because no one is learning during this debate, and that is the purpose of debating.



These are good ways to weigh the theory shell. You can, in addition, do the following:

- ❖ Run an “a priori” argument. “A priori” refers to a point that must be evaluated and accepted **before** any other arguments in the round. In other words, the judge should evaluate the theory shell before anything else. Since the theory shell is an argument about a norm for the debate, the judge should decide that norm first..
- ❖ Drop the Debater – This refers to the argument that the debater has done something wrong, has broken an important rule in debate. And you are telling the judge to “drop the debater” who broke the rule. That means that the team that did this should lose the debate.

Personally I am an advocate of traditional parliamentary debate and believe that much of the tech ideas coming in aren’t suited to our judge pool and to what parliamentary debate is supposed to be.

Should you be using tech in your debates?

First, check your judge’s paradigm BEFORE the round. Find out how they feel about tech and theory debates. If they are a lover of tech, then you may need to adapt your style to it. If they are traditionalists, avoid it.

Remember it is not enough for your team to SAY that a rule is broken. You need:

- To clearly state the rule that is broken
- Why the rule is important
- What the punishment is for breaking the rule

But bottom line, if you are successful in your theory argument, you win the round no matter how the rest of the debate goes down.

In the next chapters, you will look at some of the typical rules that tech argues have been broken by the other team. They include

- ★ speed,
- ★ topicality,
- ★ uniqueness-links-impact, and
- ★ kritiks

Chapter 26

Speed Demons

You can argue a theory that a team Speeds: Your theory argument says that the other team is breaking the rule of “debating at a speed that is understandable for both teams and the judge.”

1. If you run into debaters who are using speed (and spread), use Points of Clarification and Points of Information to understand the points they are making.
2. If they are speaking really fast, don't fall into the trap of upping your speed. Keep going at an understandable and persuasive speed. Most judges will respect that!
3. If you suspect the other team may talk fast, you can say you don't want this to be a speed or spread debate BEFORE the debate begins. And in the middle of the debate, you can say “Slower, please.” Trust me, if the debate is too fast for you to follow, it is probably too fast for most judges.
4. If the team NEVER slows down, then you can attack their speed. You tell the judge:
 - a. We asked them to go slower, and their speed has harmed the debate.
 - b. They did not go slower, so they must not want to debate with us – they want to exclude us from the round.
 - c. The judge should drop the other team because they didn't make it a fair debate and they weren't inclusive
5. Once you make that speed argument, then tell the judge you will now attack their other arguments.

How can you argue against a “Speed” Theory Argument –

1. The easiest way is to slow down. You simply say, “If I slow down” then you no longer have an argument.
2. You can argue that your speed is reasonable considering the level of debate you are at and considering that you have a great deal of material to cover.
3. You claim the other side is also speeding – therefore, it negates the entire argument.

Chapter 27

Hey – That's Not What the Motion Means!

In parliamentary debate, **Topicality (T)** is a negative argument asserting the [Affirmative](#)'s plan doesn't meet or fit under the resolution.

Topicality can be a tech or theory argument --



A topicality argument is also known as a T-shell. Topicality is a specific type of theory argument. Namely, the Negative argues that their opponent should not be allowed to win the round because they are arguing something other than the assigned topic or motion. A "**T-Shell**" (Topicality Shell) is the structured argument a team reads to argue that the way the AFF has defined the terms is not what the motion intended. They contend that they have a better (clearer, fairer, more educational) way of defining the terms in the motion. They further assert that the Affirmative's interpretation is bad and they should lose for being untropical. When arguing a T-shell, it is a procedural argument and should, thus, come before all other arguments in the first negation's speech. You want the judge to decide that the opponent's case is not meeting the resolution, and thus, the judge needs to give you the win.

When Should You Consider Running a T- shell: (or NOT running one)

- The AFF clearly doesn't meet the resolution or the intent of the resolution.
- The resolution is vague or has controversial terms.
- You want to control the debate early and force the AFF to defend a more narrow position.

Avoid a T-shell when:

- The AFF is clearly on topic, so it would be a waste of time and an argument you wouldn't win
- You don't have a standard or evidence to support your position

Parts of a T-Shell –

This includes the four parts that were discussed earlier: an interpretation of key terms, a violation showing how the Government's plan fails, standards for why the interpretation is superior, and a voter argument explaining why this issue is crucial for the debate.

Interpretation (Interp): Defines a key word or phrase in the resolution differently than the AFF defined it. Often the definition is pulled from dictionaries, legal documents, or topic-specific literature. If AFF described the word "universal" as embracing a major part or the greatest portion (as

of humankind), the NEG might argue this as not a topical definition and not what the resolution intended. Instead they might present another definition with a source.

Example: Universal means “available equitably to all members of a society.” Merriam Webster

Violation: Explains how the AFF does **not** meet that definition.

Example: The AFF’s definition has them only meeting the MAJORITY of society and does not equitably serve ALL members of a society as the resolution intended.

Standards: Reasons your interpretation is better for debate.

Example: In order to achieve fairness, we need to consider all members.



Voter: Why topicality should be a reason to vote neg. Usually framed as fairness or jurisdiction.

Example: By adopting the fairer definition presented by the NEG we serve all members of society equitably AND we show that the AFF is not topical, which is a voting issue.

How can the AFF argue against a Theory Argument on Topicality (A T-shell) –

- Begin with a “we meet” argument. The NEG has probably indicated that there is a word or phrase in the resolution that the AFF has not met, and that AFF has not interpreted part of the resolution correctly. So AFF says, we did “meet” that part of the resolution” and then explains why. AFF will need to present a counter interpretation of the resolution – in other words, you defend why your interpretation (or definition) is correct. (This would be a good place to cite a definition that fits your interpretation.)



EXAMPLE: The AFF does give a fair definition of “universal” – Merriam Webster, the same source as the Neg uses, offers this interpretation of the word: embracing a major part or the greatest portion (as of humankind); comprehensively broad and versatile. Our definition meets the meaning of the resolution.

- Present a “Do Both.” The AFF argues that their plan and the counterplan can be done at the same time. And it is actually better doing both than just the counterplan alone.
- You can also argue that NEG’s interpretation is bad – explain why the NEG’s way of defining the resolution is incorrect.

Example: This resolution suggests that the USFG should do this, but the NEG’s definition “available equitably to all members of a society” is international in scope. The resolution does not allow us to do this for every part of our world society.

- AFF argues “No abuse.” What do we mean by “no abuse.” Abuse in debate refers to tactics that undermine fair play and constructive dialogue. It also encompasses manipulative language, name-calling, excessive yelling, and tactics that silence or demean opponents, shifting focus from the topic to personal attacks or unfair advantages. You contend that AFF did not have any abuse, and therefore, their definitions should stand.

Example: Since the definition used by the AFF is legitimate, we were not abusive.

- AFF argues that the NEG has only presented “potential abuse” of the resolution, that they have not given specific, real evidence to support their topicality argument. Without real world evidence, the AFF plan should win.

Example: The NEG contends that our definition is not what the resolution intended. But if you look at our case and plan we are meeting, we have made it equitable to everyone.

- AFF maintains that topicality arguments are just a ploy to silence important voices. AFF says that the topicality argument is just being introduced to prevent the more important ideas from being debated. Aff maintains that the NEG is using rules/concepts to silence what should really be being discussed.



Chapter 28

You can present a theory argument against a “Uniqueness-Links-Impacts” Argument

In debate, the **Uniqueness-Link-Impact (U-L-I)** framework is the core structure for disadvantages and advantages, explaining why an argument matters: **Uniqueness** describes the current situation (status quo), the **Link** explains how the plan (or counterplan) changes it, and the **Impact** details the significant consequences of that change.

Used as a theory shell argument, it argues an opponent violated this logic, often claiming their argument

1. lacks uniqueness (it happens anyway),
2. has a broken link (doesn't connect to the plan) or 3. Contains an irrelevant impact, aiming to dismiss their argument or even win the round.

Obviously, if you can win this argument, it clearly destroys the other side's argument, and it would go to you.

How Can You Argue against a “Uniqueness-Links-Impacts Tech Argument;

To defeat this argument, you have to explain where the other side's logic is wrong – how you are unique, why the link you draw is not flawed, and why the impact you present will happen.

In parliamentary debate, **Uniqueness-Link-Impact** is the core structural framework used to build and evaluate disadvantages (DAs) or policy advantages.

It breaks down a causal chain into three clear parts to prove why an action or plan results in a specific outcome. [\[1\]](#)

The Three Core Components

- **Uniqueness:** Describes the state of the world right now (the status quo) *before* the round's proposed plan happens. It proves that the outcome is not already happening or inevitable on its own. [\[1, 2, 3\]](#)
- **Link:** Explains the specific action or mechanism from the plan that triggers a change. It connects what the team is doing to the shifting conditions. [\[1, 2\]](#)
- **Impact:** Details the final, terminal result of that change. It explains why the outcome matters, usually weighing magnitude, probability, and timeframe. [\[1, 2\]](#)

Strategic Uses and Attacks

- **Non-Unique:** Arguing that the impact or link is already happening in the current status quo, meaning the opposing team's plan doesn't uniquely cause it. [\[1\]](#)

- **No Link:** Claiming that the opposing team's plan does not actually trigger the causal mechanism they said it would. [[1](#), [2](#)]

Chapter

A Critique of the Kritik

You can present a Kritik as a tech or theory argument --

What is a Kritik (AKA Ks) Kritiks were introduced first to policy debate as a form of attack that attempts to redirect the focus of debate to whether or not to reject ideas which support or uphold undesirable ideology, language, institutions, or world views. Kritiks have now found their way into parliamentary debate.

Kritiks are arguments that isolate a particular aspect of the resolution or of an opponent's case that is 'problematic.' Ks can focus on big ideas like philosophy, sociology, being, identity, or even economics. They generally do not engage the resolution on its own terms but attempt to shift the discussion to a theoretical topic with, at best, only the most tenuous connection to the case or resolution.

If you were to run a kritik, you are broadly asserting that the judge should evaluate the round based on something other than the resolution. This can range from kritiks that, for example, claim the other team used unacceptable racial terms in their constructive to claims that the judge should vote against the other team for wearing shoes to arguments that the philosophical underpinnings of the opposing case are flawed -- independent of the case itself.



Fans say it is an argument that attacks important assumptions/systems of power that are a backdrop to the other side's advocacy. They say that all arguments should be valid, not just ones pertaining to the resolution. They say that no argument should be dismissed as not worthy of listening.

K critics say it is an attempt to hijack the debate and make the round about something other than the resolution. It does not belong in parliamentary debate.



Bottom line: a K advocates that the ballot should be used to reward the winner of the K rather than the side that presented stronger arguments on the assigned topic.

Personally I am an advocate of traditional parliamentary debate and believe that kritiks make us stray from what parliamentary debate is supposed to be. And I believe that the majority of our GGSA judging pool prefers a debate which focuses on the topic rather than an obscure argument possibly not even related to the resolution.

How can you argue against a kritik in debate?

The AFF argues that the kritik should not be something that the judge votes on in the debate, and you give several reasons. You should not spend a HUGE amount of time on arguing the kritik. After you have made your argument, you go back to arguing the AFF case.

Here are some of the reasons you can give the judge to reject the kritik!

Argument 1 – The kritik fails to address the resolution.

The kritik often picks up on an extraneous part of the resolution or on something the AFF has done or not done. It does not deal with the resolution for that round. Therefore, the NEG has failed to debate on the resolution.

So you argue that the NEG has failed to debate the resolution and therefore has failed to meet their burden. The AFF should win.

Argument 2 – This kritik runs counter to the spirit of Parliamentary debate.

CHSSA rules state that “Participants represent the advocates for and against a motion for debate (also known as a resolution or topic.)” A kritik is not really an argument for or against the resolution but an attempt to step outside of it. Thus a kritik doesn’t fit the rules of debate and should be thrown out. Also CHSSA says that **“Parliamentary debate is extemporaneous debating on topics that change from debate to debate.”** Kritiks tend to be pre-planned, and this is against the spirit of parliamentary debate, so the kritik should be rejected.

So you argue that the judge should throw out this argument because it does not follow parliamentary rules by sticking to the resolution and to the idea that preparation should be extemporaneous.

Argument 3 – This kritik is not fair to the Affirmation.

The AFF spends its time prepping on the resolution while the NEG instead uses its time to prep on the kritik, which is outside the resolution. The AFF know nothing about the kritik, so the NEG essentially nullifies the AFFs prep time. The NEG has the element of surprise, and thus they hijack the debate.

So you argue that this kritik is not fair, that the AFF didn’t have time to prep on it, and it hijacks the debate away from the resolution you are meant to discuss.

Argument 4 – Kritiks don’t belong in Parliamentary Debate

Parliamentary rounds are supposed to be a short-notice discussion on a general topic, not a place to discuss deep philosophic, economic, or sociologic theories. That requires far more time than a 20-minute prep time allows for. And it may require the AFF to debate on something that is obscure and they know nothing about.

So you argue that the kritik has a subject that cannot be discussed in the short time allowed and it requires the AFF to argue something that they have not had enough time to study, contrary to the pre-preparation done by the NEG.



Remember: You don’t need to argue all 4 of these – pick out the ones that work best for you. Argue them quickly and then tell the judge, **“Now, let’s return to the resolution, which is what we should be debating today!”**

Chapter 27

Metaphor Topics – Beautiful Chaos!

Sometimes for a change of pace, a tournament will use metaphor topics for a round or two. A metaphor topic is a resolution that is based on a metaphor. You may recall from your English classes that a metaphor is “the comparison of one thing to another without the use of *like* or *as*. ” For instance, these are metaphors

Conscience is a man’s compass. – Vincent Van Gogh

Chaos is a friend of mine.” – Bob Dylan

In a debate round, a metaphor topic might look like this:

This house believes that you are what you eat.

This house believes that you should know the ropes.



As you can see, like a household wrench, a metaphor topic is rather open-ended, and the Affirmative actually gets a chance to set the topic of the debate. It can be a scary round for the Negative because the Negative doesn’t know what to expect. It often can catch the Negative completely by surprise. Take a look at the metaphor topics below:

This house would push the envelope.

It would appear that this is a policy topic, and the metaphor suggests that you “go beyond that which has been done before.” The subject could be about anything where we go beyond what has been tried before. The Affirmative could use it to push space exploration beyond today’s limits, or to require much stronger testing for students in school or to try steam engine technology in cars. As you can see, the “sky is the limit” when it comes to the Affirmative choosing their case.” (That sounds like another metaphor topic to me.)

This house believes that silence is golden.

Honestly, this could be a fact, value, or policy debate, depending on how you want to interpret it. It seems to emphasize an opinion stated as a fact (fact motion), it seems to value something (value motion), and it could be advocating for the government to change its policy (policy motion). So once again, the Affirmation gets to choose what it wants to do with the motion. You could be talking about the value of listening, about how we should stop interfering in the politics of other countries, or how cell phones should be banned from restaurants.

As you can see, metaphor topics certainly can “throw a wrench” into a parli debate.

Here are some thoughts for the Affirmation

1. As a team, discuss the meaning of the metaphor carefully. Decide what the “message” of the metaphor is. Decide what kind of a motion you think it is. Did you know that typing a metaphor into Wikipedia Offline often times explains what a metaphor means? You might want to check on that with the metaphor topic you have been given.

- Once you understand the meaning and type of motion, consider current events topics where that message might be helpful. Pick a topic where you already have information – that will save you time. Look at our pro-con topic sheets and see if you see a topic that is tailor made for that metaphor. **Be careful that your case is not too outlandish – that might open you up to TOPICALITY and ABUSE attacks from the Negation.** (See below.)
- Once you have chosen the topic, you prepare the debate just as you normally would
- Plan for a little more time to frame the debate in the 1st Affirmation Speech. You will want to take time to:
 - Explain a metaphor debate to the judge – trust me, he/she doesn't know
 - Explain what your team believes is the message of the metaphor
 - Explain how your topic fits that metaphor
 It may require you to expend some time, but it will be worth it in the end.



Here are some thoughts for the Negation

What is frustrating for the Negation is that it is very hard to use your 20 minutes prep time because you have no idea of what the Affirmation is going to say. Should you sit there twiddling your thumbs? No, there are a number of things you can do:

- As a team, decide what the message of the metaphor is. Remember, just like the Affirmative can do, you can also check on Wikipedia Offline to see the meaning. You want to be prepared in case the Affirmative gets the message wrong. The Affirmative must keep the “message” of the metaphor, in other words, the spirit of the metaphor. The Affirmative must not use an unreasonable interpretation of the metaphor. It is a good idea to substitute the Affirmative's definitions into the metaphor to see if the metaphor still makes sense. If the Affirmative does not keep with the message, then the Negative could argue effectively **Topicality** – the Affirmation did not meet the intent of the resolution, and therefore is not topical. Note: As you know, you still must continue to debate the rest of the case in case the judge doesn't buy your Topicality argument. Be sure to bring it up in rebuttals as a VOTING issue.
- If the Affirmative team presents a case that is really “way out there” or only marginally close to the metaphor, the Negative can win by arguing that the Affirmative team's case is **ABUSIVE**. What does “abusive” mean in a debate? One debate manual defined it this way -



abusive: Arguments that are fundamentally unfair in some intuitive way

The Negative can argue that the entire case is unfair. Wikipedia defines it like this: abuse the resolution (i.e. allow too wide of a variety of cases to be run)

Well, that certainly happens when metaphor topics are used – way too many cases can fit the metaphor. So the Negative team can argue that the Affirmative team is abusive because the resolution “allows too wide of a variety of cases to be run” and the Negative can’t prepare for them all. In other words, it is abusive to expect the Negative to be prepared for so many potential cases and it places an unfair burden on them! But as was noted above, the judge might not buy your “abuse” argument so you need to go ahead and continue to debate the AFF case. Just make sure to emphasize your “abuse” argument as a voting issue in rebuttals.

3. You could also consider running a counterplan that contains a more reasonable, more “in line” interpretation of the metaphor resolution. Wikipedia says, “Under the competing interpretations framework, if the negative presents a better interpretation than the affirmative does, the negative wins.” The Negative can argue that the AFF’s interpretation is not “reasonable” and the Negation’s counterplan is. According to Wikipedia the “affirmative’s burden is to meet the best interpretation” of the resolution. The Negative would argue this doesn’t happen – that the Negative has a better, more reasonable definition. So the 20 minutes of the prep time could be used to come up with a reasonable counterplan. Of course, you run the risk that the AFFs case easily fits the metaphor and is reasonable. Then, your counterplan is out the window.

4.

So my final message on Metaphor debates is this: good luck to both teams and

**MAY
THE
FORCE
BE WITH
YOU**



A Compilation of Resources You Might Find Helpful

Addendum 1

The Handy, Dandy Glossary on All Things Parliamentary Debate

Here are some commonly used words and phrases related to parliamentary debate.

Basic Debate Terminology

(To) **Advocate** – To support or be in favor of something. ALL debaters advocate something in a round.

Affirmation or Affirmative – The team that is in favor of the proposition. Usually the affirmation is the team advocating change. The Affirmation usually wins when they show that:

- The status quo is extremely harmful and their new plan is better.
- They have more benefits than the Negation.
- Their value is better than the Negation.
- The fact is correct or right
- The Negation's counterplan is topical and is not workable.

Burden of Proof – When you introduce an argument, you have the responsibility of providing sufficient reasoning and evidence for the argument so that the opponent is obliged to consider the argument. Often times, the negative will say, for instance, that the affirmative has the burden of proof to show that change is necessary.

Bye round – This means that your team does NOT have to debate that round. For some reason, there is an odd number of teams entered, so one team sits out. A bye round counts as a win.

Clash -- You must directly attack arguments presented – this is called clash. If you don't directly clash with them, then the argument they presented stands.

Coin Flip – A coin is flipped, and the team that wins gets to pick the topic or the side for the debate. If they chose side, then they are allowed to wait to see what topic the other team chooses BEFORE they pick their side.

Definition of Terms – It is the Affirmation's job to define any key terms in the proposition. They must decide which terms are ones that are debatable and then they must define those terms, usually according to a dictionary. Once the terms are set, then the debate must follow that definition of terms. Some teams may try to give outlandish or very limited definition of terms. If they do, the negative must argue that the definition of terms are not reasonable, not the intent of the proposition, or not topical. (See below for more on this.)

Elimination rounds – These occur after the preliminary rounds, and in these, only the winning teams advance.

Evidence – Parli debate allows for common knowledge to be used as evidence. However, if you are quoting someone or are giving statistics (in other words, very specific evidence that not everyone knows), you must write down the source and date for that information on your flow sheet and you must state it in the debate when you give the information. If it is a quote, you must write down the quote in your notes in FULL – no ellipsis. If you are on the other side and you believe that the other team has presented a KEY piece of evidence, you can ask to see the cite reference. If they don't have it, they don't get to use that piece of information.

Fiat – for the purposes of the debate, it is assumed that a plan will pass. However, this still means the plan can be attacked for any negative effects or weaknesses it has when it passes – costs too much, can't be done quickly enough, creates big disadvantages,

Flowing the Round – Taking notes of speeches presented in the round, usually on a legal pad. When flowing, you try to write down the argument, then the other team's response, then your response across the flow sheet. That way you can see how the argument was discussed throughout the debate. You should also note when a team drops an argument.

(This) House – When "this House" is in the motion, it means that the AFF/GOV gets to determine or choose who "this House" is. In other words, it could be the USFG, California, the United Nations etc.

Negation or Negative – The team that is against the proposition. Usually the negation says that the status quo is good, is handling the problems, is better than the affirmation's plan. The Negation usually wins by

- Proving the Affirmation plan does not meet the resolution and is non-topical
- Proving that more bad will happen as a result of passing the Affirmation plan
- Proving that their value is better than the Affirmation's value
- Proving that the fact is wrong
- Proving that their counterplan is preferable to the Affirmative's plan

The Negative Block – This consists of the 2NC plus the INR speeches. It is the largest block of time that the negative has all at once. In parli debate, that is 12 minutes to attack the affirmative.

Net Benefit – The Affirmation argues that their case, in the end, has more benefits than the status quo. The Negation will, of course, come back and say that the Negation has more net benefits. So really, each side is arguing that the debate ballot should be given to the side with the most net benefits.

Point of Clarification – It is a question asked in the first two speeches that asks for clarification about any point presented in the 1st AFF or 1st NEG which pertains to their case. It is used in case a debater did not catch a contention, some evidence, a plan plank etc. The speaker must answer it. Some tournaments allow POCs and some do not.

Point of Information – It is a question or statement asked of a speaker about content in their speech. It usually is trying to highlight weaknesses in the speaker's content or understand a point the speaker is trying to make. Only one question can be asked at a time, and the speaker has the right to accept or decline taking the POI. The clock does not stop during a POI, so questions and answers should be brief.

Point of Order – This is where one team stands to declare they believe the other side is breaking a rule. Usually it pertains to the introduction of a new argument in rebuttals. Time is paused to address a POO. The team making the POO explains what the other side has done incorrectly, and the team accused is allowed to explain why they don't believe they broke the rule. The judge will take that into consideration when making his final decision.

(To) Preempt – This means that a team presents an answer to an argument that has not been presented yet. They anticipate an argument will be made, so they go ahead and answer it. This will take a little power out of the opponent's argument. A preemptive argument might start, "Now the other team is probably going to come up here and tell you that lots of people will die. Let's get this straight – that's simply not going to happen...."

Preliminary rounds – These are the beginning rounds in which ALL debate teams participate. We usually have 4 preliminary rounds.

Preponderance of Evidence – this is a judging criteria where the team tells the judge the debate should be judged on which team has the most evidence. Since parliamentary debate does not depend on evidence as other kinds of debate do, this judging criteria isn't used much.

Prep time – the set amount of time given to each team to prepare their speeches. In parli, you have 20 minutes at start and NO time in between speeches.

Proposition – This is the issue being debated in the round. The proposition changes every round in parli debate. Always write down the proposition's exact wording at the start of prep time, usually at the top of your flow sheet. The propositions sometimes begin, "This House should..." or "The United States should..." There are three kinds of propositions in parli:

- **Fact** – you will debate whether the proposition of fact is true or not. You will bring up REASONS/ARGUMENTS that show that the fact is true or not. Example: Barack Obama is a better president than Bill Clinton.
- **Value** – You will debate a value, proving which side will be valued more. Nuclear power is a better alternative to gasoline. In this debate, you would be showing that one side is preferable to the other side. In this kind of debate, you may hear the other side say that this is a net's benefit case. This means that the win in this debate would go to the side with the most benefits.
- **Policy** – You will debate whether you believe a new policy should be put in place. Generally, the affirmation will present harms with the present system (status quo), then present a SHORT plan, and finally show how this plan will take care of the harms or will be more advantageous than the status quo. In my opinion, this is the hardest one to do effectively.

Rebuttal – This is the speech where you present your winning issues or voting issues. You can also organize it as your points of clash and explain why your side won them. You should not go straight down the flow, but come up with a new organization that shows the judge why you deserve the ballot.

Responses, answers, or extension of arguments – This is the argument that addresses an opponent's argument. You ALWAYS want to respond to or break down the arguments presented by the other side.

Status quo – The status quo is the "way things are right now" or our present system. It is the present systems of laws and attitudes. Usually you will hear this term in a proposition of policy. The affirmation is usually against the status quo, saying that the status quo has created many problems and that a new plan/policy is necessary to take care of the harms. The negation is for the status quo. Also, the negation will always try to show that the status quo already has in place the mechanisms or laws to take care of any problems, saying that a whole new system is not necessary.

Tagline – This is a shortened version of the claim or argument. A tagline is only used once the full claim is stated.

Voting issues – These are usually the issues that you believe are the most important and are key to the debate. If you win them, then your team wins the debate. In rebuttals, you want to summarize the key issues (the voting issues) that you believe you won, and therefore, the judge should vote for you. Always say to the judge – "Here are the voting issues in today's debate and we won them."

Weighing the Issues – Usually in rebuttal, a team member weights the issues. They will try to show that they have won more issues than the other side. Or they may say that some issues are more important than others, and they won those important issues. For instance, you might hear, “Yes, our plan may cost a little money, but we’ve shown you it will significantly save many lives. Doesn’t the saving of lives outweigh a small cost issue?”

Terms Related to the Affirmation’s Case

Advantage – the claimed benefits of a plan of action. The Affirmation says that their plan will provide several advantages or benefits through its adoption.

Harm – This is a problem in the status quo. The affirmation will argue that there are harms in the present system that need to be taken care of by a change in policy or a new plan.

- Quantitative Harm – a measurable harm such as financial costs, deaths, illness, etc. that can be presented in statistics.
- Qualitative harm – a non-measurable harm but one which will affect the quality of the systems such as rights, happiness, freedom etc. being curtailed

Inherency – The Affirmation says there is a problem that is a part of the current system or status quo and that the only way to get rid of the problem is to completely change the system itself. They argue that there is a barrier preventing the adoption of the plan in the present system. In other words, the present system can’t take care of the harms presented – only the Affirmative’s plan can do it. Of course, the Negative will argue that the status quo already has built-in ways to solve the problem – that a whole new Affirmative plan is NOT necessary. They contend that the problem is not inherent in the system.

Plan – The Affirmation’s suggestion for taking care of the problems/harms presented. It is an outline for change.

- Planks – These are sub-points of the plan.
- The plan should include the actor, the mandate, the timeline, and the enforcement

Solvency – Does the plan/policy change solve the problems/harms? The Affirmation argues that their plan solves the problems; the Negation says the plan will not work or is not better than the present system.

Uniqueness – something is unique only to that plan or side. Affirmative may argue that the advantages they present are unique to their plan – in other words, the only way to get that advantage is through the adoption of their plan. The negative may argue that the harms presented by the Affirmation are not unique to the status quo – that those harms will still exist under the Affirmation plan.

Terms Related to the Negation’s Case

Counterplan – A negative tactic where the Negation agrees that the present system doesn’t work, is harmful, and is flawed. They essentially agree with the harms presented by the Affirmation, but then they say, “But we have a better plan to take care of this than the Affirmation does. We have a plan that will work better.” Some people believe that a counterplan must be non-topical – in other words, outside the definition of terms while others say that a topical counterplan is allowable. If you are on the Affirmation, always argue that a counterplan must be non-topical – if it is a topical plan, then you win.

Disadvantage – This is a harm resulting from the adoption of the Affirmation's plan or from the value they are supporting.

Link – A causal relationship – You must show cause and effect links. For example, one team says there is pollution. Then they say 100 animals died. Is there a direct causal link – in other words, is it proven that the pollution actually caused the animals to die? Negative teams should always question causal links. Affirmative teams can do it, as well, with the contentions presented by the negative.

Plan Meet Need Argument – This is a negative attack which argues that the Affirmation's plan will not solve the harms that they have presented.

Topicality – this is the idea that the Affirmative plan must fall under the proposition being debated. Topicality is usually a negative attack run in the 1NC where the Negation contends that the Affirmation's plan does not meet the definition of terms.

- First the Negation discusses the definition of words in the Proposition. They propose what they believe is a reasonable definition.
- Next, they say that the Affirmative plan does not fall under or meet the definition of terms that are reasonable to accept.
- Finally, they tell the judge that this is a voting issue. The Affirmation is not topical and does not meet the definition of terms.

Addendum 2

Speaking “Advanced Parli”

Getting Fluent in the Tougher Vocabulary

Abusive – Arguments that are in some way unfair for the other side.

Competition/Competitiveness – when a debater says a plan “must be competitive,” they mean that the plan must be mutually exclusive and superior in net benefit to the counterplan the negative team is running. A plan is “competitive” if it cannot be done at the same time as the counterplan and it offers a better overall outcome than the counterplan alone.

Collapse – It is the strategic narrowing of focusing down to 2 or 3 key issues during rebuttals, allowing debaters to concentrate on winning arguments rather than spreading themselves too thin. A team narrows their rebuttal to their STRONGEST arguments, weighs them against the other side’s arguments and the initial weighing mechanism (judging criteria), and shows the judge why these are vital and give you the debate.

Kritik – Kritiks are arguments that isolate a particular aspect of the resolution or of an opponent’s case that is 'problematic.' They generally do not engage the resolution on its own terms but attempt to shift the discussion to a theoretical topic with, at best, only the most tenuous connection to the case or resolution.

Metaphor topic – A metaphor topic is a resolution that is based on a metaphor. And a metaphor is “the comparison of one thing to another without the use of *like* or *as*. “ Usually the phrase “This House” precedes the metaphor. Example: This House believes that laughter is the best medicine. Often, these topics are very open-ended and give the AFF the chance to choose how to apply the metaphor. In the example above, the AFF could decide what “medicine” refers to.

Mutually exclusive – The counter plan and the AFF plan cannot be done at the same time. It is the NEG’s job to show that their plan cannot be done concurrently with the AFF plan

Opportunity cost – The opportunity cost is a calculation of the value of whatever you have to sacrifice when you are making a choice between two mutually exclusive alternatives. It is the benefit we forego when we trade off one alternative for another. Simply put, an opportunity cost is the lost benefit from choosing one option over another (i.e. the cost of not doing something. It really is just a downside or disadvantage.

Permutations – A permutation is an argument offered by the affirmative to demonstrate the non-competitiveness of a counterplan; it suggests a specific way that the plan and counterplan can be combined or done at the same time in order to avoid the negative disadvantage. A perm is one of the more common arguments by the affirmative to attack a counterplan.

Shell – a structured, written-out procedural argument used to claim that the other team broke a rule or made the debate unfair. Instead of arguing about the topic itself, a shell focuses on the rules and fairness of the round.

Theory – Usually this is a debate about debate. This says that an argument or position has broken unspoken rules or conventions of debate. It is similar to calling a foul or throwing a challenge flag in sports. When

bringing up a theory argument, a team must say what rule is broken, why this rule is important, and what the punishment should be.

Topcality – Topicality asks whether *the plan actually addresses the topic or resolution*. If the affirmative's plan is too narrow, too broad, or uses a definition that the negative thinks is wrong or unfair, the negative can win on topicality. If the judge agrees, the affirmative's case may be dismissed, and the negative should win the round. In short, **topicality is about making sure the debate stays on the assigned topic**.

T-shell (Topicality Shell) – This is the format used for topicality arguments. It is a structured argument that generally says that the opponent's case falls outside the resolution. The format includes

- an interpretation – what the resolution or a word/phrase from the resolution actually means
- Violation, – how the AFF or GOV interpreted it instead
- Standards/Reasons to prefer — In other words, why is your interpretation better
- Voters – what the judge should do about it and why

Voters – These are the arguments that you tell the judge you won. Usually they are the impacts of the arguments that were your strongest.

Weighing mechanisms – Ways to compare AFF and NEG arguments, by showing that one should be weighed more heavily than the other side when deciding a ballot. It says that, if both impacts/arguments are true, which one is more important.

Addendum 3

A Tasty Sampling – Some Past Parli Topics from Tournaments

California should support amnesty for undocumented workers.

California should ban new residential construction in the Wildland-Urban Interface.

The United States should abolish SCOTUS (the Supreme Court of the United States).

Developing nations should choose to protect their own industries rather than be more open to trade.

The nationalization of energy sectors does more harm than good.

The United States should eliminate in-person voting and institute all mail-in voting.

When in conflict, the public's right to know ought to be valued above the right to privacy of candidates for public office.

The USFG should enforce the ban on Tiktok.

In Western liberal democracies, people ought to be allowed to sell their own non-vital organs.

The feminist movement ought to support the narrative that "beauty does not matter" over the narrative that "all bodies are beautiful."

The United States should significantly reduce soybean subsidies.

Placing political conditions on humanitarian aid to foreign countries is unjust.

A US Supreme Court expansion is justified.

The United States Federal Government should ban private funding of federal elections.

California should amend its constitution to abolish elections for judges.

USFG should ban the pesticide Roundup.

United States humanitarian intervention in other countries does more harm than good.

CA should abolish its system of ballot initiatives.

The expansion of school choice through charter schools has decreased the quality of public education.

Exploitation of oil-rich countries is a global crisis.

The United States Federal Government should increase funding in its infrastructure for rural broadband access.

California should prioritize alleviating poverty over fixing infrastructure.

The United Kingdom should significantly reduce restrictions on farm imports from the US.

The USFG should withdraw all troops from South Korea.

Rent control policies do more harm than good.

School vouchers do more harm than good.

California should significantly increase its investment in vehicle electrification.

California should significantly increase investment in desalination technology.

The USFG should require that all eligible individuals vote in presidential elections.

Rehabilitation should be prioritized over retribution in the US criminal justice system.

The USFG should offer Puerto Rico full statehood contingent on a binding referendum

The USFG should reduce the length of pharmaceutical patents to 8 years.

The USFG should impose term limits on all members of Congress.

The USFG should impose limits on the length of Supreme Court appointments.

The USFG should increase the federal minimum wage to \$15 per year.

The USFG should implement a universal basic income.

The USFG should significantly increase the federal gas tax.

The USFG should significantly increase investment in asteroid mining.

Remember, some topics may begin with “This House” – in this case, the Affirmative gets to decide who “this house” is. Here are some samples of “The House” topics.

This House believes that the US should impose tariffs on the products of companies that shut down US manufacturing plants and outsource jobs.

This House welcomes the increasing automation of labor.

This House supports environmental activists breaking the law in order to protect the environment.

This House would break up major technology monopolies.

This House would implement a universal basic income.

This House believes that genetic editing of human embryos is unethical.

This House would impose economic sanctions on countries that fail to meet climate goals.

This House supports the expansion of the European Union.

This House believes that developed nations have a moral obligation to accept all climate refugees.

This House would forgive all student loan debt.

Addendum 4

Starting off on the Right Foot -- Effective Parli Introductions

Parli introductions must be short, friendly but effective. I don't like the old, over-used "I'd like to thank my partner, my opponents and our judge for making this debate possible."

A good parli Introduction does the following:

1. Makes you seem friendly and likable – so smile, check to see if everyone is ready
2. Introduces your subject – Just a couple of sentences (no more) that open the subject. See below for a few more ideas
3. States the resolution and the side you are taking – We of the Affirmation believe strongly that we must pass today's resolution, ... or The resolution we are debating today is....., and we of the Affirmation strongly support passage of this resolution.
4. Gives a roadmap to where you will go in the debate. You don't always need to say "roadmap." You can use words like "outline, the direction I will take, the order, the course, I will arrange my presentation, I will present my case in the following manner..."



And all this should happen in about 20 seconds – no more!

Some generic ways to introduce you subject:

1. Across the nation, all of us are worried about _____. And steps need to be taken to _____ (You insert a general position)
2. It has recently been splashed across the headlines of our newspapers and has cropped up on the nightly news – what subject am I talking about? You fill it in with the subject
3. I am still in high school, but I am already concerned about
4. President Obama (or Congress or the Supreme Court) has recently brought the subject of _____ to our attention. They have highlighted our need to consider changes to _____. Today we tackle this important subject as we debate. The resolution before us is:
5. When you hear the word _____, what are you thinking about? What questions are you asking? Today we are considering the question of _____. The exact resolution is: _____.

Addendum 5

What's A Speaker to Do?

Cheat Sheets for Novices

On the following pages, you will find some “cheat sheets” that look a lot like a flow sheet. These cheat sheets tell each speaker “what they are supposed to do” during their constructive speeches and rebuttals. In each column, you will see, step-by-step, what you should say and do in each speech. There is one cheat sheet for “fact and value” debates and another one for “policy” debates. (Be sure to use the right one!) When you are first starting out, it is sometimes hard to remember all the things that you need to do – it’s a lot to handle for a novice debater. Using these sheets is a great way to help you get through your first debates and stay organized, as well. You can use them in one of two ways –

1. Use them during your 20 minutes of prep, so that you make sure you cover everything as you build your case, or
2. Use them to glance at WHILE you are giving your speech.

Once you get more experienced, these cheat sheets won’t be necessary. It will all have become second-nature to you.

Addendum 6

Some Philosophic Ideas Important to Debate

Moral Imperative (or Moral Obligation):

It is something that must happen because it is the right thing; A moral imperative is an ethical responsibility. A line of conduct or behavior judged as the right one, by a majority of people within a community. An obligation or imperative is a duty or a command to act in a certain way. When the obligation is based on moral and ethical considerations, it is a moral duty. Moral obligations can arise from three sources.

1. Law-Based Moral Obligations. Good citizens have a moral as well as a legal obligation to abide by laws; it is part of the assumed social contract of a civilized society. If a law is unjust, however, (such as those that mandated ethnic and religious persecution during the Nazi regime and those that discriminated against a person on the basis of race in South Africa and elsewhere) there may be a moral obligation to disobey it under the specific and demanding doctrine of civil disobedience.

2. Agreement-Based Moral Obligations. The second source of moral obligation is agreement. Even if an agreement doesn't reach the level of an enforceable contract, there is a moral obligation to do the things we agree to do, especially if others are counting on us to do so. For instance, you agree to pay monthly payments toward your mortgage.

3. Moral Principle as the Basis of Moral Obligation. The third source of moral obligation is moral principle, a standard of conduct that exists irrespective of laws or agreements. The great German ethicist, Immanuel Kant is largely responsible for this idea – that we must do this because, within us, we know it is the right thing to do. (Josephson Institute, 3 Sources of Moral Obligation, 2/14/11)

In debate, you may argue that a plan, an idea, a law must be put in place because we have a moral imperative to do so. Moral imperative could also be a judging criteria or weighing mechanism..

Social Contract:

A social contract is an unwritten agreement between the people and their government. Citizens agree to obey laws and give up some of their total freedom. In exchange, the government promises to protect their safety, rights, and property. The idea of the social contract is one of the foundations of the [American political system](#). English philosopher Thomas Hobbes is primarily responsible for this theory of a social contract.

Jean Jacques Rousseau and John Locke each took the social contract theory one step further. Rousseau explained that the government is based on the idea of [popular sovereignty](#). Thus the will of the people as a whole gives power and direction to the state. He argued that a fair government is only valid if people freely agree to it. Citizens trade total freedom for protected, equal rights by obeying laws they make together. John Locke stressed the role of the individual. He believed that revolution was not just a right but an obligation if the state abused their given power. Obviously these ideas had a huge impact on the [Founding Fathers](#), especially [Thomas Jefferson](#) and [James Madison](#).

In debate, you might be arguing that we need to pass a law, follow a course of action etc. because it is really part of our social contract to our citizens.

Human Rights

Human rights are **rights** inherent to all **human** beings, whatever our nationality, place of residence, sex, national or ethnic origin, color, religion, language, or any other status. We are all equally entitled to our **human rights** without discrimination.

Human rights include civil and political rights, such as the right to life, liberty and freedom of expression; and social, cultural and economic rights including the right to participate in culture, the right to food, and the right to work and receive an education. Human rights are protected and upheld by international and national laws and treaties.

The Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR) was adopted by the United Nations General Assembly on December 10th, 1948. The Universal Declaration was the first time that countries agreed on a comprehensive statement of inalienable human rights. It is a vision for human dignity, committing governments to uphold the fundamental rights of each person. Here are the abbreviated rights listed in each of the articles of the Declaration of Human Rights:

1	Right to Equality	16	Right to Marriage and Family
2	Freedom from Discrimination	17	Right to Own Property
3	Right to Life, Liberty, Personal Security	18	Freedom of Belief and Religion
4	Freedom from Slavery	19	Freedom of Opinion and Information
5	Freedom from Torture & Degrading Treatment	20	Right of Peaceful Assembly and Association
6	Right to Recognition as a Person before the Law	21	Right to Participate in Government and in Free Elections
7	Right to Equality before the Law	22	Right to Social Security
8	Right to Be Heard by Competent Tribunal	23	Right to Desirable Work; to Join Trade Unions
9	Freedom from Arbitrary Arrest and Exile	24	Right to Rest and Leisure
10	Right to Fair Public Hearing	25	Right to Adequate Living Standard
11	Right to be Considered Innocent until Proven Guilty	26	Right to Education
12	Freedom from Interference with Privacy, Family, Home & Correspondence	27	Right to Participate in the Cultural Life of Community
13	Right to Free Movement in and out of the Country	28	Right to a Social Order that Articulate this Document
14	Right to Asylum in other Countries from Persecution	29	Community Duties Essential to Free and Full Development
15	Right to a Nationality and the Freedom to Change It	30	Freedom from State or Personal Interference in the above Rights

In debate, you might be arguing that a law must be passed, a policy must be followed, or a value must be a priority because it involves a basic human right.

Values:

1. Values are important and lasting beliefs or ideals shared by the members of a culture about what is good or bad and desirable or undesirable. Values have major influence on a person's behavior and attitude and serve as broad guidelines in all situations. Some common business values are fairness, innovation and community involvement.

2. The monetary worth of something in areas such as accounting, economics, marketing or mathematics.

In debate, you may be arguing that something is a value that is threatened, that a value must be protected by law, that one value is more important to people than another.

Addendum 7

Straight from the Horses' Mouth – CHSSA and NPDL Rules that Govern Parliamentary Debate

CHSSA Rules for Parliamentary Debate As of June 2026

Section 1. Rules for All Forms of Debate

A. Enforcement

1. In ruling on protests for violation of debate rules set forth in this Article, the Protest Committee shall consider the total facts and circumstances associated with the violation including whether it
 1. was intentional or unintentional,
 2. was unethical and/or dishonest,
 3. would be considered abusive
 4. was intended to obtain an unfair advantage in the debate-
 5. violates the purpose behind a rule in addition to its express language, and the degree of prejudice resulting to the opponent from the violation.
2. Unless another penalty is included in any specific rule, the Protest Committee is empowered to impose any of the following penalties:
 1. warning and/or reprimand, including a statement of clear consequences for a repeated violation.
 2. require the round be repeated under terms considered fair and just by the Committee
 3. impose a loss on the debater(s) in violation
 4. Disqualification
3. Debaters may not make an agreement among themselves or with the judges to modify the rules in this article. Judges should not direct students to deviate from these rules or encourage students to violate them.

A. Definition of 'Round'

1. A round shall begin in Policy Debate, Lincoln-Douglas Debate, and Public Forum Debate when the first speaker in the debate begins their speech, and shall end when the last speaker in the debate ends their speech.
2. In Parliamentary Debate a round shall begin when the resolution for the round is released and the round ends when the last speaker in the debate ends their speech.
3. Debate Both Sides of Resolution as Assigned. Over the course of the tournament, each team or individual in Policy Debate, Parliamentary Debate, Public Forum, and Lincoln-Douglas Debate may be assigned to uphold either side of the resolution in any given round.

A. Definition of 'Speech Time'

1. Except for roadmaps, speech time begins as soon as the debater begins speaking. Thank-you's count toward speech time.
2. Roadmaps do not count toward speech time, so long as:
 1. The roadmap is not to be argumentative in nature;
 2. The roadmap does not exceed 15 seconds.

A. Restriction of Communications

1. During a round, a debater shall not communicate through any method with anyone other than that debater's partner (if applicable), the opposing debater(s), and the judge(s).
2. Oral prompting, except time signals, by the debater's partner while the debater has the floor, is discouraged though not prohibited and may be penalized by some judges.
3. A debater may, however, refer to their notes and materials and may consult with their partner while both they and their partner do not have the floor.

A. Electronic Retrieval Devices

1. A computer is defined as a laptop, netbook, iPad, or other portable electronic retrieval equipment. Devices such as flash drives or external hard drives are not considered computers.
2. Once the first speaker in the debate begins their speech, Cellular phones may be used during the round for the exclusive purpose of functioning as a timer (device must be put into airplane mode and be incapable of receiving or sending correspondence). Penalty for violation of this rule shall be automatic forfeiture of the round by the offending side. Students must make all cell phones used as timers available for inspection by judges and/or tournament officials upon request. A cell phone used as a timer shall not be counted as one of the computers/electronic retrieval devices allowed in a specific debate event.
3. Debaters shall not have access to or activate any electronic retrieval devices during the round, except those explicitly allowed by this article.

A. Validity of Evidence

1. Definition of Terms:
 1. Evidence is quoted information read in the round and must be identified by source.
 2. Distortion of evidence exists when the evidence itself contains added or deleted words that do not clarify, but, in fact, change the position of the author with respect to the issues in question.
2. Responsibility for Evidence. Debaters are responsible for the validity of all evidence read in the debate. In all rounds of debate, all debaters shall have available, if challenged by the opponent during any round, complete citations for each piece of evidence introduced including the name of the author, qualifications, complete source title, complete date and page number. Lack of a full citation shall void any effect of that piece of evidence in the round. Either no internal ellipsis (ellipses occur after the first word of the quotation and before the final word) may be used in evidence cited on a card (this must be the case in Parliamentary Debate because no outside materials other than notes on provided colored paper may be brought into the round), or ellipses must be shown on document, if the original source or a photocopy is present. In Policy Debate, Lincoln-Douglas Debate, and Public Forum Debate the evidence may be read in ellipsed form, but the entirety of the evidence must be available in one of the two ways cited. Personal letters, electronic messages, telegrams, and the like are not admissible as evidence.
3. Evidence challenges – all forms of Debate.
 1. The burden of proof rests with the individual that challenges the validity of any evidence.
 2. The individual/team challenging evidence must indicate prior to the conclusion of the round that a challenge will be made and indicate the specific evidence to be challenged.

3. The round will be completed and the judge(s) will withhold decisions, returning ballots to the tournament tabulation room. Decisions will be rendered on the ballots only after the protest has been resolved by tournament officials. The judges may be asked if the evidence in question was or would have been significant in their decision.
 4. The evidence challenge must be made within thirty minutes of the conclusion of the round by the adult sponsor or designated representative of the individual/team who initiated the challenge.
 5. The challenging individual/team must be able to provide proof of the charge, within a reasonable time as set by tournament officials, through the use of either original copies of photocopies of the source in question or be able to demonstrate that there is reasonable cause to believe the evidence is nonexistent through the use of photocopies of books in print, periodical guides or other types of bibliographical resources.
 6. The tournament committee will adjourn to a private area with the two individuals and examine the charges and evidence along with materials presented by the challenging individual. Adult coaches or sponsors may be present during the examination.
 7. Individuals utilizing "handbook" evidence rarely have available the facilities to check all sources found in those handbooks. Handbook evidence proven inaccurate will be disallowed in the round, and judges instructed to not consider the evidence in rendering a decision.
 8. Evidence proven to be falsified or distorted from the original source will be grounds for awarding the challenging individual/team a win and disqualifying from the tournament the individual/team found guilty of using falsified or distorted evidence.
 9. If the evidence challenge is not upheld, the judges will be asked to render a decision and turn in their ballots after they have been informed that the evidence in question was not found to be falsified or inaccurately presented.
 10. The tournament committee has one-half hour to hear arguments and examine evidence and must render a decision within fifteen minutes of the conclusion of the presentations. The round following the contested round may not begin until the dispute is resolved.
4. Evidence Exchange/Note-Taking.
1. Judges may not request nor be given any evidence or written material from teams/individuals except when the evidence is challenged as illegal by the opposing team/individual during the round. The evidence in question should be collected by the judge and delivered to the Tournament Committee.
 2. In Policy Debate, Lincoln-Douglas Debate, and Public Forum Debate, teams or individuals may request evidence from opponents during cross examination/cross-fire or preparation only. The specific evidence cited must be provided. The requesting team must have access to the evidence during their subsequent speech, but must return it at the conclusion of that speech if requested. In Parliamentary Debate, the opposing debaters may ask to see the debaters' notes containing any cited material as part of a Point of Information and the team reading the cited materials must show the handwritten notes, with citation, upon such request.

Section 4. Parliamentary Debate Rules

- A. Round Definition
 - 1. A parliamentary debate team consists of two debaters.
 - 2. A parliamentary debate round consists of one Government team debating against one Opposition team.
 - 3. The Government team proposes a case to uphold the resolution. The Opposition team opposes the Government team's case.
- A. Resolutions
 - 1. Resolutions will be announced by the tournament at the start of preparation time.
 - 2. A different resolution will be used each round.
- A. Round Format
 - 1. Prime Minister Constructive (PMC): 7 minutes, given by the first Government speaker
 - 2. Leader of Opposition Constructive (LOC): 8 minutes, given by the first Opposition speaker
 - 3. Member of Government Constructive (MGC): 8 minutes, given by the second Government speaker
 - 4. Member of Opposition Constructive (MOC): 8 minutes, given by the second Opposition speaker
 - 5. Leader of Opposition Rebuttal (LOR): Rebuttal 4 minutes, given by the first Opposition speaker
 - 6. Prime Minister Rebuttal (PMR): 5 minutes, given by the first Government speaker
- A. Preparation Time
 - 1. Debaters shall have 20 minutes of preparation time between the time the resolution is announced and the time debaters report to their judge(s).
 - 2. The two partners may communicate with each other. Debaters are also allowed to communicate with tournament officials to clarify tournament logistics. Other than that, debaters are not allowed to communicate with anyone by any means during preparation time.
 - 3. During preparation time, debaters may consult both physical and electronic copies of any material, including both prepared notes and published sources. Debaters may use computers and the internet to store and to retrieve this material.
- A. Round Rules
 - 1. There is no preparation time between speeches. The next speaker must begin their speech (or their roadmap) within 20 seconds following the preceding speech.
 - 2. Debaters are not allowed to access computers during the round after preparation time has ended.
 - 3. After preparation time has ended, a debater is not allowed to access any written material except notes that were handwritten on paper by the debater or their partner after the resolution was announced.
 - 4. Judges should disregard new arguments (including new responses) during rebuttal speeches, regardless of whether a Point of Order was raised. The exception is that the PMR may respond to new arguments made in the MOC. New analysis of prior arguments is allowed in rebuttal speeches.
- A. Points of Information
 - 1. A Point of Information (POI) is a single short question or statement addressed by a member of the opposing team to the debater who has the floor.
 - 2. The debater who has the floor may accept or decline each POI at their discretion. Follow-up POIs are only allowed if separately recognized by the debater who has the floor.
 - 3. POIs come out of the speech time of the debater who has the floor, so time should not be stopped for a POI. Each POI may not exceed 15 seconds.

4. POIs are only allowed in constructive speeches. POIs are not allowed in the first or last minute of any speech.
- A. Points of Order
1. A debater may raise a Point of Order if they believe that the opposing team is bringing up a new argument in a rebuttal speech. Points of Order may not be used for any other purpose.
 2. Points of Order are not allowed during constructive speeches but are allowed at any time during rebuttal speeches.
 3. To raise a Point of Order, the debater shall state "Point of Order." Time should then be immediately stopped. The debater then has 15 seconds to explain why an argument made by the opposing team is new.
 4. The opposing team then has 15 seconds to respond to the Point of Order. Once the response is finished, time should immediately resume.
 5. Debaters should not use Points of Order as a tactic to disrupt their opponent's speech.
 6. Judges should not announce their rulings on Points of Order during the round.
- A. Evidence
1. The intent of Parliamentary Debate is to encourage extemporaneous argumentation. Debaters should primarily rely on logic and general knowledge. Reference to published sources is allowed but should be limited.
 2. A debater may refer to information from a published source during their speech. The debater must transcribe the full quotation this information is based on. The transcription must be done during preparation time, by hand, and without ellipses. The debater must then write down the citation and must say the citation during their speech. To the extent that these are provided by the original source, the citation should include the name(s) of the author(s), the source title, and the publication date.
 3. The team which refers to information from a published source must show the opposing team the sheet of paper containing the quotation and citation if requested. The request can be made during a POI.
- A. CHSSA State Tournament Logistics
1. Resolutions for each shall rotate through the following types:
 1. Value: Both sides push for their value in the topic as superior to the other team's value.
 2. Policy: Proposition shows there is a problem and offers a solution (plan) to the problem. Both sides debate the appropriateness and/or merits of the problem and solution asserted by the Proposition.
 3. Fact: Both teams debate the circumstances under which the topic would be called a true statement
 2. The topics for each round will be in a distinct topic area not to be used in any other round for the duration of the tournament. The topic areas and resolution type by round will be determined by the Debate Committee and communicated to the tournament director at the January meeting. Only topic areas will be announced at the January meeting. At least five resolutions based on each topic area will be written by the tournament director or designee and vetted by at least three members of the debate committee prior to the start of the state tournament. These individuals shall be selected by the Debate Committee Chair from members of the Debate Committee that do not have any Parliamentary Debate teams entered at the State Tournament, using any criteria the Debate Committee Chair deems appropriate. If there are not at least three eligible members of the Debate Committee based on the foregoing, then the Debate Committee Chair may make up the shortfall by selecting a non-Debate Committee Member familiar with debate that has no Parliamentary Debate entries at the State

Tournament. Three final resolutions will be selected for each topic area and placed into a sealed envelope by round to be used in a blind draw for topic selection each round.

3. The tournament director may determine the location(s) where debaters should be present during preparation time.
4. The two members of a team who qualify to the State Tournament from a league state qualification tournament must debate as a team in the State Tournament.
5. Please note: CHSSA cannot guarantee access to wireless internet or electrical outlets in a tournament space and it is the duty of the debaters to ensure appropriate access.

RULES FOR THE NATIONAL PARLIAMENTARY DEBATE LEAGUE

As of June 2026

Students who appear in a round more than a designated time after the end of the preparation period shall automatically forfeit the round.

Sometimes the system below is used for choosing topics, but sometimes, they just announce the topics.

System: Each round shall have three possible topics. Before the preparation period, teams shall strike topics as follows: The Opposition team shall strike one of the three topics, and then the Government team shall strike one of the remaining two.

ARTICLE XII: PARLIAMENTARY DEBATE RULES

XII.2: ROLES

I: A*. A debate consists of two teams. The Government team consists of two debaters - the Prime Minister and the Member of Government. The Opposition team consists of two debaters - the Leader of Opposition and the Member of Opposition.

B. The Government proposes a case to uphold the resolution. The Opposition opposes the Government's case.

XII.2: RESOLUTIONS

A. Resolutions will be announced by the tournament at the start of preparation time.

B. A different resolution will be used each round.

XII.3: SPEECH TIME

A. Except for brief non-argumentative roadmaps and content warnings, speech time begins as soon as the debater begins speaking.

B. The judge shall not factor into their decision any arguments made by a debater outside of that debater's allotted speech time.

XII.4: FORMAT

A. Prime Minister Constructive (PMC): 7 minutes

B. Leader of Opposition Constructive (LOC): 8 minutes

C. Member of Government Constructive (MGC): 8 minutes

D. Member of Opposition Constructive (MOC): 8 minutes

E. Leader of Opposition Rebuttal (LOR): 4 minutes

F. Prime Minister Rebuttal (PMR): 5 minutes

G*. Debaters have 20 minutes of preparation time between the time the resolution is announced and the time they report to their judge(s) to start the debate.

H. There is no preparation time between speeches.

XII.5: POINTS OF INFORMATION

A. A Point of Information (POI) is a single short (< 15 seconds) question that a member of the opposing team asks a debater giving a constructive speech.

B. The debater who has the floor may accept or decline each POI. A follow-up question is a separate POI.

C. Speech time does not stop during a POI.

D. Debaters may not raise POIs during protected time, which shall be the first and last minute of any constructive speech, unless invited to do so by the debater who has the floor.

XII.6: POINTS OF ORDER

- A. A debater may state “Point of Order” to object to a new argument in a rebuttal speech. Time should then be stopped. The debater then has 15 seconds to explain why an argument made by the opposing team is new. The opposing team then has 15 seconds to respond to the Point of Order.
- B. Judges may choose whether to announce their rulings on Points of Order. If there is a judge panel, judges may not announce their rulings on Points of Order during the round. Time shall resume immediately after a judge announces a ruling on a Point of Order. If the judge does not announce a ruling, time should resume immediately after the response is finished.
- C. Judges should disregard new arguments (including new responses) during rebuttal speeches, regardless of whether a Point of Order was raised. The exception is that the PMR may respond to new arguments made in the MOC. Rephrasing or new analysis of prior arguments is allowed in rebuttal speeches.

XII.7: POINTS OF CLARIFICATION

- A. A Point of Clarification is a question that a member of the opposing team asks a debater giving a PMC or an LOC. The question shall aim to clarify the speaker's advocacy or interpretation of the resolution.
- B. The speaker may not decline a Point of Clarification.
- C. Speech time stops for Points of Clarification and resumes once they are answered.

XII.8: COMMUNICATION DURING THE ROUND

- A*. During the preparation time and the debate:
 - a debater may not communicate with anyone other than their partner, their opponents, their judge(s), and tournament staff;
 - judges and tournament staff may not help the debaters with their debate performance.
- B. While a debater has the floor, they may communicate with their partner in writing, but not verbally.
- C. A debater may communicate with their partner, both verbally and in writing, while their opponent has the floor, so long as this does not disrupt their opponent's speech.

XII.9.1: MATERIALS ALLOWED IN IN-PERSON DEBATES

- A*. Debaters are not allowed to access computers after preparation time ends (except a device used only as a timer and in “airplane mode” if available).
- B*. A debater may access notes that were handwritten on paper by the debater or their partner after the resolution was announced. The debater may access notes that were handwritten on paper and given to them by the opposing team after the resolution was announced. The debater may access and refer to a printed copy of the tournament round rules. Other than that, the debater may not access any written material after preparation time ends.

XII.9.2: MATERIALS ALLOWED IN ONLINE DEBATES

- A*. After preparation time ends, debaters may not access evidence not found during preparation time.
- B. During the debate, debaters may access and refer to the tournament round rules.

XII.10: MATERIALS ALLOWED IN PREP

- A. During preparation time, debaters may consult both physical and electronic copies of any material, including both prepared notes and published sources. Debaters may use computers and the internet to store and to retrieve this material.

XII.11: EVIDENCE

- A. Debaters should primarily rely on logic and general knowledge.
- B. Debaters should not cite published sources during the round. Judges should enforce this rule by giving a claim supported by a citation the same weight as they would give a claim not supported by a citation.

XII.12: JUDGE CONDUCT

- A. The judge should award a win to the team that did the better debating.
- B*. The judge must award a win to exactly one team.
- C*. The judge may not confer with anyone when making their decision. The exception is that the judge may communicate with tournament staff to clarify rules.
- D*. The judge must be present and conscious during all speeches.
- E*. The judge may not interrupt any speech. The judge may not make verbal comments about any arguments in the debate before every judge in the round has selected the winning team on their ballot (except see 6.B). Judge comments are permissible as needed to address immediate technical or logistical issues.
- F*. A judge should not judge a round for which they have a conflict (see XI.7).

XII.13: ENFORCEMENT

- A. During the debate, these round rules shall be enforced by the judges. Judges should not direct students to deviate from these rules or encourage students to violate them.
- B. Sub-sections also enforceable by the Protest Committee (see XIII.1) are marked with an asterisk.

XII.14: SCOPE

- A. This Article shall be used at tournaments run by NPD. The Board may, by a unanimous vote, modify these rules for a particular NPD tournament held during that Board's term.
- B. Any tournament not run by NPD may adopt the NPD round rules. Such a tournament may specify in its invitation any round rules which deviate from the NPD rules.
- C. The tournament director may make exceptions to any of these round rules in order to accommodate persons with disabilities.

Tab 2

Tab 3

